

RIFT ASCENDANT · WARDEN'S EDITION

The Shadow of the Regent

A mature S-Rank Gate Domain horror campaign for Levels
1-15, set inside the Gloamreach.

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Rift Ascendant Lore: Gate Domains and the Gloamreach

Rift Ascendant Gate Domain Lore

Source Authority

This document is the campaign-facing lore source for The Shadow of the Regent. It defines how high-rank Rifts, Gate Domains, Anchors, pantheon signatures, and Regent law work for this module.

The Remade World

The Remade World is a modern world of Sanctuary Cities, Bureau cordons, Ascendant guilds, Essence markets, arcology transit, mana-lattice infrastructure, and threshold zones shaped by Rift response doctrine.

The material side is where people live, trade, license Ascendants, argue over contracts, and wait under the light of a Rift. The Gate Domain is where the horror happens.

Rifts, Gates, and Gate Domains

A Rift is the breach. A Gate is the stabilized threshold. A Gate Domain is the place beyond it.

Most low-rank Gates open into limited chambers, short ruin-complexes, forests, tunnels, labs, or pocket battlefields. High-rank Gates can open into whole interior realms: valleys with weather, roads, settlements, citadels, dead seas, predator forests, buried archives, or chained regions that obey a hostile logic.

The Gate is not the adventure location. It is the door.

The Domain beyond the door can be large enough to trap armies.

Anchors

Every persistent Gate Domain has an Anchor. The Anchor keeps the threshold stable and gives the Domain its laws.

Common Anchors include:

- a ruling Anomaly intelligence;
- a Regent;
- a Relic engine;
- a domain heart;
- an Essence furnace;
- a bound pantheon signature;
- a living ecology that has become self-aware.

Clearing a Gate means breaking, sealing, transforming, or extracting the Anchor. Killing every creature inside a Domain is not enough if the Anchor remains intact.

Blue Phase and Red Phase

Blue Phase means the Gate is open but contained. The Bureau can measure the threshold, issue Rank clearance, deploy Ascendants, and maintain a cordon.

Red Phase means containment has failed. The Gate Domain begins to overwrite the material side. Weather crosses first, then terrain, then Anomalies, then the Anchor's law. This event is a Gate Break.

The Bureau does not call a Gate safe because it understands it. The Bureau calls it safe while its instruments still have numbers.

Ascendants and Bureau Classification

Ascendants are people whose mana-lattice resonance lets them survive and act inside Gate Domains. Their Jobs, Paths, Ranks, and clearances are Bureau classifications over observable phenomena.

The AFA is a device and record layer. It reports resonance, Rank estimates, Gate timers, Anchor instability, injury data, contract status, and Bureau warnings. It does not grant destiny.

Pantheon Signatures

The Eternals and Exarchs rarely appear as people inside a campaign. They leave signatures.

- Xylo appears in archives, impossible ledgers, preserved truths, and records that survive destruction.
- Cipher appears in cold judgment, crystalline stillness, and truths held in absolute silence.
- Lyra appears in mutation, swarms, predatory adaptation, and Gate ecologies that learn.
- Sylph appears in broken distance, moving thresholds, impossible roads, and wind through sealed rooms.
- Nyx appears in ambush, hunger, pack law, and the moment Rank fails before instinct.
- Marthos appears in deletion, rot, failed containment, and the mercy of ending what cannot be saved.
- Solara appears in shields, triage light, last stands, and protection that burns the protector.
- Golem appears in walls, foundations, bastions, and the refusal of a line to fall.
- Vaelen appears in trials, battle doctrine, escalating challenge, and war made ritual.
- Elara appears in beauty made unbearable, art that keeps survivors human, and comfort twisted into bait.
- Kronos appears in clocks, thresholds, sequence, and consequences that arrive exactly when promised.
- Kael Voss appears in umbral command, extracted echoes, and sovereign power that refuses collapse.

In the Gloamreach, pantheon signatures are environmental pressure rather than divine visitation. Xylo clings to Bureau ledgers that should have burned. Cipher hardens the Black Vault into silent judgment. Sylph bends the Gallows Road. Marthos stains the Essence Mill and Red Phase mercy-horror. Solara and Golem linger in last stands at the Bastion, Aegis Hollow, and the White Heron Reliquary. Vaelen marks

trial roads and Citadel challenge rites. Elara turns hospitality into bait. Kronos measures the Blue Phase clock and Citadel sequences. Kael Voss echoes through the Regent's sovereignty, umbral command, and refusal to collapse.

Regents

A Regent is not merely a powerful Anomaly. A Regent is domain authority with will. When a Regent becomes the Anchor of a Gate Domain, the land itself acts like a body and a court.

Regents do not simply wait in final rooms. They send invitations, alter roads, bargain through Relics, punish settlements, elevate servants, and study intruders. Their horror is not size. It is ownership.

Subject Zero

Subject Zero is an older sealed S-Rank Anomaly whose pressure leaks into some high-rank Domains. It is not the Regent. It is not loyal to the Regent. It is an outside hunger that can offer power through forbidden bargains.

When Subject Zero touches a Domain, the bargain should be real, useful, and costly.

The Gloamreach

The Gloamreach is the S-Rank Gate Domain of The Shadow of the Regent. It is a country-sized interior realm behind one Rift. It has roads, settlements, ruins, mills, warrens, predator ranges, a fallen bastion, a forbidden vault, and a citadel visible from almost everywhere.

The Regent is the Gloamreach's Anchor.

The material side matters only as the place the party leaves, the place the Gate may break into, and the place that must live with the ending.

Campaign Tone

The Shadow of the Regent is hard horror inside a Gate Domain:

- scarcity without mercy;
- settlements surviving by tribute;
- Ascendants reduced from elite operators to trapped intruders;
- Bureau failure recorded in clean language;
- Vermillion pragmatism that saves and exploits;
- Anomalies as ecology, punishment, livestock, and law;
- Relics that solve problems by teaching the party to think like the Domain;
- a Regent who is charismatic, predatory, and patient.

The campaign should feel modern in tools and institutions, but the adventure space is the Gate Domain. Roads should be wrong. Weather should judge. Safe places should feel leased, not owned. Every clear should ask what law the party broke to survive.

Chapter 0: Day Zero - The Memory-Care Wing

Day Zero - The Memory-Care Wing

A Gate that feeds on memory is not merely an opening. It is the first time a place learns your name.
- Dr. Serin Hayashi, private margin note

Purpose

Run this one-to-two session gothic-horror prelude before the party enters the Gloamreach. The characters are still on the material side, inside the Bureau cordon surrounding the S-Rank Gate. The Memory-Care Wing is a small pocket breach created by pressure leaking from the Gloamreach. It introduces the campaign's real themes: memory, ownership, hospitality, civilian cost, and the terror of a Domain that reaches through the door before anyone steps inside.

The party begins at Level 1 and reaches Level 2 at the end of this chapter.

The Hook - Welfare Check

A shuttered hospital wing inside the cordon has gone silent. It houses elderly civilians who could not be moved when the Bureau perimeter collapsed inward. The night staff missed their check-in. A drone pass showed the windows fogged from inside. No portal is visible, but the AFA readings show a low-rank pocket breach behind one resident's bathroom mirror.

Read aloud:

The dispatcher slides a cracked tablet across the counter. The image shows a brick hospital wing behind temporary Bureau fencing. Every window is fogged white from the inside. "Twenty-three residents, six staff, no confirmed hostiles. We have senior Ascendants preparing for the S-Rank threshold. You are what we have left. Be careful. Most of them will not understand what is happening."

The Wing

The building is too warm. The heat is off. A radio plays static in a language no one recognizes. When the party crosses the threshold, each character makes a DC 10 Sense save. On a failure, the character forgets a harmless but personal detail for one hour: a badge number, a favorite song, a friend's birthday, the smell of home.

This is not a punishment. It is a warning.

Keyed Rooms

R1. Reception - The Visitors' Log

The reception desk is clean. A potted orchid has been freshly watered. A visitors' log sits open.

Every entry is written in the same hand. Different names. Same ink. Same arrival time. Same departure time. The next blank line already has the first stroke of a party member's name.

Clue: the handwriting matches Ms. Park Jeong-hye in R4. Writing a name in the log grants advantage on the next Sense save in the Wing, but the Regent's agents can recognize that character by name later.

R2. Dayroom - The Wrong Afternoon

Five residents sit watching a news broadcast from years ago. Sunlight fills the room even though the windows face the wrong direction. The residents are echoes. They cannot be harmed and cannot meaningfully answer questions.

Hidden under a folded blanket is the Faded Family Photo: a young woman in a wedding dress beside a man in Bureau dress uniform. The man's face has been worn down to blank paper. The inscription reads: Jeong-hye and [name erased], June 1978.

This photograph is the campaign's first major emotional relic. If the party carries it into the Gloamreach, the Regent notices the absence immediately.

R3. The Hallway That Lengthens

The hallway stretches as the party walks. Framed photographs age as the characters pass: birthdays, hospital beds, empty chairs, blank frames.

Encounter: The Forgetting, a D-Rank memory swarm.

Use a simple swarm profile: HP 22, AC 12, speed 30 ft., vulnerable to radiant. It makes two chill-touch attacks at +4 to hit for 1d4 cold damage. On a hit, the target makes a DC 13 Sense save or suffers disadvantage on the next check made in the hallway.

Escape condition: the hallway resolves when a character stops trying to move forward and turns back toward the dayroom. The Domain rewards surrendering control, but remembers who did it.

R4. Room 12-B - Ms. Park Jeong-hye

Ms. Park lies awake in bed, staring at the ceiling. Her heart monitor beeps even though it is not plugged in. She repeats the same line every twelve seconds: "He was supposed to come home for lunch."

A gentle Presence check, DC 10, gives one moment of lucidity. She remembers that her husband was an Ascendant. She remembers a uniform. She remembers pride. She does not remember his name. When she tries to say it, the sound does not reach the party.

R5. The Mirror - The Diagnosed

The bathroom mirror is open. Violet frost crawls across the frame. The creature halfway through the glass has a face made from every person Ms. Park has forgotten.

Boss: The Diagnosed, D-Rank elite. HP 28, AC 13, speed 20 ft., immune to psychic and necrotic, vulnerable to radiant.

Actions:

1. Forgetting Touch. Melee +5 to hit, 1d6+2 cold. On hit, DC 13 Sense save or the target loses reactions until the end of their next turn.
2. Mirror Retreat, once per fight. The Diagnosed enters the mirror and returns at the end of its next turn beside a reflective surface.
3. Forgetting Gaze, recharge 5-6. 15 ft. cone. DC 13 Sense save. On failure, the target takes 2d6 psychic damage and gains the Regent-Marked condition.

When The Diagnosed falls, the mirror cracks and the pocket breach begins to collapse.

The Warden's Choice

The party has one choice before the Wing collapses.

Destroy the mirror. The breach ends completely. Ms. Park dies with perfect clarity, smiling at someone the party cannot see. The residents are found dead but peaceful. The party gains Bureau reputation. The Faded Family Photo remains whole.

Seal the mirror. Ms. Park and several residents survive. The haunting remains dormant. The party gains Vermillion or civilian reputation. A grief-cult scout notices the party's mercy and reports it to the Awoko.

This choice should echo in the Gloamreach. If Ms. Park dies, the Regent's human-form reveal is colder and more incomplete. If she survives, she can appear at the Bureau cordon during the finale and create one round of hesitation when the Regent remembers who waited.

Regent-Marked Condition

A character marked here becomes visible to the Regent's law. The Regent and his servants can recognize the character's presence inside the Gloamreach. The character has disadvantage on Stealth checks against Regent-aligned entities, and the Regent may communicate through dreams, reflective surfaces, or written invitations.

The mark is removed only if the Regent releases it, the Anchor is resolved, or a major divine or Relic-tier intervention breaks the claim.

Design Notes

This chapter is horror first and combat second. Let silence work. The residents are civilians, not props. The point is not whether the party can win a fight. The point is what kind of people they are when a Gate asks them to choose between mercy and certainty.

Chapter 1: Warden's Briefing - Entering the Gloamreach

The Shadow of the Regent

Campaign Overview

The Shadow of the Regent is a non-linear horror sandbox for 3-6 Ascendants, taking characters from Level 1 to Level 15. It is set inside **the Gloamreach**, an S-Rank Gate Domain behind one stabilized threshold.

This is not a city-district crisis and not a cluster of unrelated Gates. The material world is the staging ground. The campaign space is the Domain.

The Gloamreach contains roads, settlements, predator woods, tithe sites, drowned archives, ruined bastions, black-market shelters, forbidden vaults, and a citadel visible from almost everywhere. The Regent is the Anchor. His rule is expressed through weather, law, hospitality, ledgers, servants, Relics, and invitation.

Opening Situation

No Ascendant or Bureau team has gone inside yet, so the Bureau can only rate the Gate from its threshold instruments — a provisional low/E classification that reads like a routine high-density clear. The reading is honest and wrong. Once the party is deep enough inside, the truth becomes undeniable: the Gate opens into a coherent interior realm large enough to swallow teams, distort distance, and produce settlements under foreign law. As containment slips toward Red Phase, the threshold turns unreliable behind them.

The party enters as the first available Ascendant team. Their mission is to identify the Anchor, recover the Three Claims, prevent Red Phase collapse, and survive long enough to decide what kind of ending the Gloamreach deserves.

Running This Module

This campaign is built at Curse of Strahd scale:

1. The Domain is the adventure location.
2. The Regent recurs throughout the campaign.
3. Travel is dangerous and meaningful.
4. Settlements are unsafe compromises, not rest stops.
5. Key Relics are placed through oracle logic.
6. Faction choices matter.
7. The finale is a citadel and Anchor-throne confrontation.

Session 0 Checklist

- Establish mature horror expectations.
- Confirm hard limits and safety tools.
- Tie every Ascendant to a reason to enter the Gloamreach.
- Explain that some threats are meant to be survived, bargained with, escaped, or legally contradicted rather than killed.
- Establish that the Regent is not merely a monster. He is Domain authority.

Ascendant Creation Hooks

Hook	Description
Bureau Deployed	You were ordered into the Domain under emergency clearance.
Guild Raider	Your Guild sees salvage, cores, Relics, and leverage.
Missing Team	Someone you know vanished during the first response wave.
Name in the Ledger	Your name appears in a recovered Regent writ.
Researcher	You need to prove how Regent Domains work before the Bureau's caution seals what is really inside this one.
Grief-Bound	The Gloamreach contains a voice, face, or memory you thought was gone.

Milestone Leveling Guide

Milestone	Level
Complete Day Zero or first threshold clear	2
Survive the first Domain road crisis	3
Earn a faction's trust or save a settlement	4
Clear the first major Domain site	5
Survive or legally repel the Regent's Bailiff	7
Resolve the first settlement's tribute crisis	8
Obtain a Claim or Regent Relic	10
Reach the Forbidden Vault or fallen bastion	12
Enter the Regent's Citadel	13
Resolve the Anchor (campaign climax)	15

Chapter 2: The Three Claims

The Three Claims

Overview

The Three Claims are Relic-level contradictions in the Regent's rule. They are not simple loot drops. Each one proves that the Gloamreach does not fully belong to him.

Without the Claims, the Regent's Anchor structure is nearly impossible to resolve. With them, the party can weaken his laws, force contradictions in his court, and survive the final confrontation.

The Claims

The Void Claim

A sphere of absolute darkness that devours light, sound, and false testimony. It weakens the Regent's ability to hide truth or erase routes.

The Abyss Claim

A crown, chain, or black iron writ that whispers promises of authority. It weakens the Regent's command over roads, invitations, and compelled obedience.

The Blood Claim

A blade, vessel, or living seal that remembers who paid for the Domain before the Regent claimed it. It weakens the Regent's ability to treat people as property.

Placement

Use Chapter 24's Oracle Reading to place the Claims. Each Claim should be in a different major Domain region unless the Warden intentionally wants a compressed or brutal campaign.

Default possible locations:

1. The Gate Threshold.
2. The Road of Writs.
3. The Tithe Mill.
4. The Predator Woods.
5. The Drowned Ledgerfen.
6. The Remembering Orchard.
7. Bastion Golemfall.
8. The Vermillion Outpost.
9. The Forbidden Vault of the Unseated Law.
10. The Regent's Citadel.

Final Confrontation Effects

Claims Held	Effect
0	The Regent's Anchor law is complete. He regenerates, ignores most contradiction, and controls the battlefield freely.
1	One Domain law can be suspended for one round during the finale.
2	Two major Regent abilities are weakened or delayed.
3	The party can force the Anchor-throne to answer: break, seal, transform, or inherit.

Warden Guidance

Do not present the Claims as mandatory keycards. Present them as dangerous evidence. Each one should help the party, but also teach the Regent more about them.

Chapter 3: The Gloamreach Region Guide

The Gloamreach Region Guide

Overview

The Gloamreach is a country-sized interior realm behind one S-Rank Gate. The Domain is large enough for travel to matter, settlements to differ, and the Regent's citadel to dominate the horizon without being immediately reachable.

Core Regions

The Gate Threshold

Where the party enters. Bureau instruments briefly function here, then begin reporting impossible distances, duplicate life signs, and old team telemetry.

The Road of Writs

The main road through the Domain. It changes distance based on invitation, debt, and names entered into ledgers. The road is not neutral terrain. It is a legal instrument.

Tribute Settlements

Each settlement survives through a lie. One claims tribute is voluntary. One claims the missing are honored. One survives by forgetting names. None are safe for free.

The Predator Woods

An adaptive hunting ground. It remembers tactics, blood, campfire smoke, and fear.

The Tithe Mill

A mill, workhouse, or counting-yard where tribute is processed and sent toward the citadel.

Bastion Golemfall

A fallen defensive fortress. This is the campaign's ruin of failed protection, last stands, and old oaths.

The Vermillion Outpost

A black-market shelter inside the Domain. Vermillion saves people and exploits them. Both facts are true.

The Forbidden Vault

The seat of the Unseated Law, the sealed residue of the Domain's prior Anchor. This is the campaign's forbidden bargain location.

The Regent's Citadel

The final castle-scale dungeon and visible symbol of the Regent's ownership.

Travel Rules

Roll once for every major journey or whenever the party refuses an invitation, travels without tribute, or carries a Claim openly.

d6	Road Event
1	The road lengthens. Lose time and supplies.
2	A toll-house appears where none stood before.
3	A messenger delivers an invitation from the Regent.
4	A settlement bell rings in the distance. Someone is being collected.
5	The Regent's Bailiff crosses the road ahead.
6	The party finds a safe-looking shelter. It has a ledger by the door.

Mana Exposure

Long rests outside protected settlements require a DC 10 Vitality save. On a failure, the character dreams of the citadel and wakes with disadvantage on the first Sense check of the day.

Chapter 4: Factions and Reputation

Factions and Reputation

Overview

The Gloamreach is shaped by factions trying to survive, profit, rule, worship, or escape. Reputation affects supplies, shelter, intelligence, betrayal, and final-act support.

Reputation Tiers

Tier	Name	Effect
-2	Hostile	Faction attacks, sabotages, or reports the party.
-1	Distrusted	No services, higher prices, guarded speech.
0	Neutral	Basic interaction.
+1	Trusted	Discounted services, side quests, better information.
+2	Allied	Safe shelter, faction support, possible final-act aid.

The Ascendant Bureau

Leader: Commander Park Jae-won **Base:** Bureau Domain Response Annex outside the Gate **Goal:** Maintain containment, recover teams, prevent Red Phase collapse, preserve official control.

The Bureau is useful, disciplined, underinformed, and politically afraid. It can save lives, but it will also classify inconvenient truths.

The Vermillion Guild

Leader: Guildmaster Orin **Base:** Vermillion Outpost inside the Gloamreach **Goal:** Extract salvage, rescue useful survivors, profit, and prove the Bureau is too slow to lead.

Vermillion moves fast and does not wait for permission. Their help is real. Their invoices are also real.

The Awoko Cult

Leader: The Hollow Mother **Base:** Hidden sanctum, moving through grief-dense sites **Goal:** Use the Regent's law to force an ascension beyond Rank, then inherit the Domain.

The Awoko preach remembrance, but their rituals turn grief into fuel.

The Regent's Court

Leader: The Regent **Base:** The Citadel **Goal:** Preserve ownership, collect tribute, test intruders, and make the Domain's claim permanent.

The Court is not a normal faction, but reputation still matters. Courtesy, defiance, betrayal, guest-right, and broken promises are all tracked.

Chapter 5: Bureau Domain Response Annex

Bureau Domain Response Annex

Overview

The Bureau annex is the material-side command post outside the S-Rank Gate. It is the party's last reliable taste of the modern world: floodlights, barricades, medics, drones, tablet maps, exhausted analysts, and a Gate that refuses to behave like a door.

Key Areas

Operations Center

Commander Park briefs teams here. The main display shows the Gate Threshold, then static, then maps that update with impossible roads.

Quartermaster Station

Basic gear, mana rations, glow rods, smoke grenades, medkits, and Bureau tactical armor. Higher-tier stock requires trust.

Medical Bay

Dr. Serin Hayashi treats survivors and studies Domain-touched tissue. She is one of the first Bureau researchers willing to say the quiet part aloud: killing the Regent may not be the only possible Anchor resolution.

Communications Room

Relay operators attempt contact with teams inside the Gloamreach. Messages arrive out of order. Some are from tomorrow. Some are from dead teams.

Key NPCs

Commander Park Jae-won

A disciplined Bureau officer trying to keep panic from becoming policy. He wants containment, but he is not blind to the Bureau's failures.

Quartermaster Lin Mei-hua

Controls equipment access. Practical, dry, and more generous when no one is watching.

Dr. Serin Hayashi

Researcher, physician, and dangerous thinker. Believes Regent Domains are legal/metaphysical structures, not just monster lairs.

Agent Kira Blackwood

Intelligence operative with classified orders involving pre-threshold Relic activity. Her secrecy can become either betrayal or confession.

Chapter 6: The Vermillion Outpost

The Vermillion Outpost

Overview

The Vermillion Outpost is a black-market shelter inside the Gloamreach. It exists because Vermillion entered early, moved fast, and paid costs the Bureau would still be debating.

The outpost has food, heat, illegal Runes, wounded civilians, salvage stalls, smuggled batteries, and more guns than official policy allows.

Areas

Core Exchange

Buy and sell Anomaly cores at better rates than Bureau standard. Vermillion asks fewer questions and remembers more favors.

Rune Stall

Contraband Runes and Sigils. Expensive, useful, and sometimes cursed by local Domain law.

Field Kitchen

A hot meal grants 1d4 temporary HP for one hour, but food is scarce. If the party eats free, someone else does not.

Bounty Board

Bounties include missing teams, dangerous roads, unpaid toll-houses, Domain beasts, and rumors of Claim locations.

Orin's Office

Guildmaster Orin keeps maps on the walls. Every map disagrees. He trusts none of them and all of them.

Chapter 7: Downtime in a Hostile Domain

Downtime in a Hostile Domain

Downtime inside the Gloamreach is never fully safe. It is time bought from hunger, tribute, weather, and the Regent's attention.

Downtime Actions

Rest Under Guest-Right

Requires a settlement, outpost, or protected camp. Safe unless the party has violated local law.

Gather Rumors

Learn one clue about a Claim, settlement crisis, road law, or the Regent's next invitation.

Repair and Refit

Restore damaged gear, reload consumables, and prepare for travel.

Study Domain Law

Make an Intelligence or Sense check. On success, learn one way to contradict a local law.

Treat Trauma

A character may clear one minor fear, hallucination, or memory distortion if another character spends the downtime helping them.

Downtime Complications

d6	Complication
1	A messenger arrives with an invitation.
2	A settlement demands tribute for shelter.
3	Food spoils overnight.
4	Someone dreams of the Citadel and wakes speaking the Regent's words.
5	Vermillion calls in a favor.
6	The road outside has moved.

Chapter 8: First Domain Site - The Hollow Subway

First Domain Site - The Hollow Subway

Overview

The Hollow Subway is a low-rank Domain site near the Gate Threshold. It looks like a modern transit station folded into old stone. Trains arrive with no tracks. Announcements name passengers who have not entered yet.

Purpose

This site teaches the party three truths:

1. Modern infrastructure cannot be trusted inside a Domain.
2. The Regent's law can use familiar spaces as masks.
3. Leaving is harder than entering.

Key Scenes

The Platform

A train arrives. Its doors open onto candlelit courtrooms, hospital halls, flooded tunnels, or the same platform ten years older.

The Ticket Gate

The turnstiles require a fare. Money works poorly. Names work too well.

The Engine Car

A minor Relic, Claim clue, or dead team AFA can be found here. If the Oracle placed the Void Claim in this site, it is hidden in the firebox of a train that has never burned fuel.

Exit Condition

The party exits when they understand what the station is asking for and refuse to pay with identity. Clever alternatives include false tickets, shared fare, destroying the ledger mechanism, or invoking Bureau jurisdiction with a successful Presence or Intelligence check.

Chapter 9: The Drowned Ledgerfen

The Drowned Ledgerfen

Rank and Role

Rank: D **Recommended Level:** 2-3 **Campaign Role:** Early Domain site, Bureau horror, first proof that records can become predatory.

Overview

The Drowned Ledgerfen is a flooded hospital-archive where the Gloamreach stores names, debts, diagnoses, casualty reports, and death certificates that have not happened yet. The building rises from black water like a half-sunk civic complex. Its corridors smell of antiseptic, ink, wet paper, and old blood. This location is not a separate Gate. It is a region of the Gloamreach.

Domain Law

Law: A recorded condition becomes easier to enforce. **Lie:** The ledgers are medical records. **Tribute:** Each protected patient must surrender one memory of being healthy. **Failure:** The Ledgerfen updates the diagnosis to terminal.

Key Areas

Intake Causeway

A narrow walkway crosses black floodwater. Clipboards hang from posts. If a character signs a form, they gain advantage on the next medical or investigation check here, but the Domain learns one true physical weakness.

Triage Ward

Abandoned beds sit in rows. Some have patients made of wet paper and bone. They ask the party to read their names aloud. Doing so restores their faces, but summons a ward attendant.

Records Basin

Shelves descend into water. The party can recover survivor lists, dead-team logs, or a Claim clue. Each search requires a DC 13 Investigation check. On a failure, the searcher finds their own name on a future casualty report.

The Catalog's Chamber

The Catalog is a crystalline record-entity. It is not initially hostile. It trades information for information: a true memory, a Bureau password, a real name, or a confession.

Information available:

1. The Regent's Citadel moves closer to those who accept invitations.
2. The Road of Writs cannot follow someone whose name has been legally contradicted.
3. One of the Three Claims is hidden where tribute is processed.
4. The Regent's Bailiff can be delayed by forcing it to read an invalid charge.

The Specimen Vault

A half-transformed survivor floats in a sealed pod. Freeing them creates a possible ally and angers the Ledgerfen, which has already classified them as deceased.

Boss: The Head Surgeon

Use a C-Rank controller profile. It treats wounds as paperwork errors and tries to correct living bodies into approved forms.

Suggested traits:

- Multiattack with scalpel and restraint injection.
- Surgical Precision, crits on 19-20.
- Emergency Protocol at half HP, summoning paper-bodied orderlies.
- Anesthetic Cloud, 15 ft. cone, DC 13 Vitality save or unconscious for 1 minute with repeat saves.

Loot and Clues

- D-Rank and C-Rank cores.
- Surgical Relic or precision blade.
- Ledger clue toward one Claim.
- If the Oracle placed the Void Claim here, it is sealed inside a diagnosis written in the Regent's hand.

Chapter 10: The Fungal Depths

The Fungal Depths

Rank and Role

Rank: D **Recommended Level:** 2-4 **Campaign Role:** Adaptive ecology, body horror, first Lyra-aspected pressure site.

Overview

The Fungal Depths are caverns beneath the Gloamreach where rot has learned bureaucracy. Mushrooms grow in rows like filing cabinets. Spore-clouds carry copied voices. The deeper the party goes, the more the caverns imitate places the characters have slept.

Domain Law

Law: Anything that remains long enough is cultivated. **Lie:** The fungus only eats the dead. **Tribute:** A settlement may dispose of grief, corpses, and secrets here. **Failure:** The secrets grow bodies and walk home.

Key Areas

The Glowing Cavern

Beautiful, warm, and dangerous. Standing still for more than a minute requires a DC 10 Vitality save or hallucinations impose disadvantage on the next perception-based check.

The Mycelium Maze

A DC 13 Survival or Sense check keeps the party on course. On failure, they loop for one hour and each character saves against spore exposure.

The Nursery

Anomaly-pods grow new bodies around old secrets. Destroying pods is safer. Reading their labels teaches more.

The Root Confessional

The fungi repeat confessions surrendered by nearby settlements. A character may learn a local lie, but must make a DC 13 Sense save or speak one true regret aloud.

Boss: Mycelium Hive Queen

Use a C-Rank brute/controller. It clings to ceilings, drags targets through poison water, and regenerates while touching the cavern network. Fire stops regeneration for one round.

Loot and Clues

- Spore-sac Relic.
- Purified mycelium crystal.
- Claim clue hidden inside a pod that has grown around a Bureau badge.
- If the Void Claim is here, it is encased in white mycelium that refuses light.

Chapter 11: The Remembering Orchard

The Remembering Orchard

Rank and Role

Rank: C **Recommended Level:** 4-5 **Campaign Role:** Travel horror, beauty turned predatory, settlement-memory crisis.

Overview

The Remembering Orchard is a vast grove of black-barked fruit trees. Each fruit contains a memory. Some are sweet. Some are rotten. Some are not from anyone alive.

Local villagers come here to surrender memories as tribute. In exchange, the Regent's court leaves their homes untouched for one season.

Domain Law

Law: What is willingly forgotten may be legally owned. **Lie:** The Orchard takes only pain. **Tribute:** One memory per household. **Failure:** The Orchard chooses its own harvest.

Key Areas

The Harvest Gate

A wooden arch with hooks for lanterns and name tags. Tags without names are safer but anger the caretakers.

The Sweet Rows

Eating fruit grants a short boon and a memory that does not belong to the eater. Too many stolen memories risk personality bleed.

The Rot Rows

Rotten fruit whispers accusations. Searching the area can reveal the name of a betrayed NPC or the location of a hidden Claim.

The Caretaker's Shed

Tools are clean, sharp, and labeled with family names. The Caretaker is not cruel. That makes them worse.

Boss: The Orchard Caretaker

Use a C-Rank stalker/controller profile. The Caretaker prunes memories, not branches.

Suggested abilities:

- Pruning Hook, melee bleed and memory disorientation.
- Graft Memory, forcing a target to make a Sense save or attack the wrong creature once.
- Harvest Bell, summoning orchard thralls.

Loot and Clues

- Memory fruit that can answer one question truthfully.
- Orchard knife Relic.
- If the Blood Claim is here, it hangs from a tree that grows only names instead of fruit.

Chapter 12: The Ashen Counting-House

The Ashen Counting-House

Rank and Role

Rank: C **Recommended Level:** 4-6 **Campaign Role:** Bureau corruption, debt horror, fire-and-ledger dungeon.

Overview

The Ashen Counting-House is a burned financial hall inside the Gloamreach. It is always burning and never consumed. Ledgers survive the fire. People do not.

The Regent's court uses this site to calculate tribute owed by settlements, factions, and intruders.

Domain Law

Law: Debt survives death. **Lie:** The ledger only records what was owed. **Tribute:** Cores, food, names, and years of service. **Failure:** Interest is collected in flesh, memory, or heirs.

Key Areas

Burning Lobby

Extreme heat. Without protection, characters take minor fire damage over time. The fire does not spread randomly. It burns documents in the order the party needs them.

Safe Deposit Hall

Every box contains something owed or stolen. Opening one requires either a key, a debt, or a successful DC 15 tools check.

The Audit Floor

Ashen auditors question the party. Honest answers are safer but may create legal vulnerabilities.

Vault of Unpaid Years

A vault contains suspended civilians who traded future years for safety. Freeing them creates a settlement crisis.

Boss: The Auditor of Embers

Use a C-Rank/A-Rank hybrid depending on party level. It attacks with burning writs, debt chains, and summoned cinder clerks.

Loot and Clues

- Fire-aspected Relic.
- Debt ledger naming a compromised faction agent.
- If the Abyss Claim is here, it is locked in a box that opens only for someone who admits what they owe.

Chapter 13: The Sunken Tunnels

The Sunken Tunnels

Rank and Role

Rank: B **Recommended Level:** 6-7 **Campaign Role:** Claustrophobic travel, drowned infrastructure, old-city horror.

Overview

The Sunken Tunnels are a drowned under-road beneath the Gloamreach. Some passages resemble subway lines, sewers, bunkers, or old evacuation corridors. The water is black, cold, and full of voices.

Domain Law

Law: What sinks is still owed. **Lie:** The tunnels are a shortcut. **Tribute:** Breath, warmth, and names of the drowned. **Failure:** The route fills behind the party.

Key Areas

Flood Gate

The entrance seals after the party descends. Opening it from inside requires solving which name belongs to which drowned voice.

The Deep Trench

A long swim or raft crossing. Something large follows below without attacking until someone speaks.

Shrine of Wet Candles

The Awoko maintain a shrine here. Their candles burn underwater. Destroying the shrine angers the Hollow Mother but weakens one cult ritual.

Air Pocket Chapel

A place to rest, but only if the party leaves a light burning for the drowned.

Boss: The Abyssal Leviathan

Use a B-Rank aquatic solo. It grapples, drags, and separates. It should feel less like a fish and more like the tunnel's hunger given muscle.

Loot and Clues

- Cold or water-aspected Relic.
- Awoko ritual evidence.

- If the Blood Claim is here, it is inside the Leviathan's ribcage, still beating.

Chapter 14: Bastion Golemfall

Bastion Golemfall

Rank and Role

Rank: B **Recommended Level:** 7-8 **Campaign Role:** Fallen knightly fortress, failed protection, heroic tragedy.

Overview

Bastion Golemfall is a ruined fortress built around a broken wall that once held back the Regent's court. Its defenders are gone, but their oaths remain. Armor stands at posts with no bodies inside. Siege bells ring when no one pulls the ropes.

Domain Law

Law: A line once sworn must be held. **Lie:** The defenders failed because they were weak. **Tribute:** Service at the wall after death. **Failure:** The dead draft the living.

Key Areas

Broken Gatehouse

The gate opens only for those who swear to defend someone else before themselves.

Hall of Empty Armor

Each suit offers a vision of the final siege. Accepting a vision grants tactical insight and psychic strain.

The Wall That Fell

A battlefield encounter against oathbound dead and siege constructs.

Commander Without a Body

A spirit commander can become an ally if convinced the party intends to break the Regent's ownership rather than conquer it.

Boss: The Oath-Forge Colossus

Use a B-Rank construct solo. It cannot be defeated permanently while an active oath remains unresolved in the Bastion.

Loot and Clues

- Shield or armor Relic.
- A banner that grants advantage against fear effects once.

- If the Abyss Claim is here, it is welded into the commander's empty helm.

Chapter 15: The Obsidian Spire

The Obsidian Spire

Rank and Role

Rank: A **Recommended Level:** 8-9 **Campaign Role:** Vertical trial, temptation, approach to the endgame.

Overview

The Obsidian Spire rises from a field of glass-black stone. Each floor is a trial of authority: command, obedience, sacrifice, ambition, mercy, and memory. The higher the party climbs, the more the Spire addresses them as potential rulers.

Domain Law

Law: Power proves jurisdiction. **Lie:** Climbing is the same as earning. **Tribute:** Weakness confessed and weaponized. **Failure:** The Spire grants power to the worst possible version of the climber.

Key Areas

Floor of Kneeling Statues

Every statue has a party member's face. Some kneel. Some rule. Some are broken.

The Watcher's Gallery

The Watcher offers bargains. None should be pure traps. The best temptations are genuinely useful.

Trial of Command

The party must lead unwilling spectral soldiers without treating them as disposable.

Trial of Mercy

A defeated enemy asks for the kind of mercy they denied others.

Boss: The Spire Guardian

Use an A-Rank tactical guardian. It copies the party's strongest tactic after seeing it once.

Loot and Clues

- A-Rank Relic or Sigil.
- Prophecy fragment about the Citadel.
- If any Claim is here, it is offered by the Watcher as a bargain with a visible cost.

Chapter 16: The Regent's Citadel

The Regent's Citadel

Rank and Role

Rank: S **Recommended Level:** 10 **Campaign Role:** Final castle-scale dungeon and Anchor-throne confrontation.

Overview

The Regent's Citadel should be visible for most of the campaign. It is not just the final dungeon. It is the Domain's argument that ownership is inevitable.

Approach only when the party has enough allies, Claims, information, or desperation to survive.

Citadel Structure

Outer Court

Invitations are checked. False names may work once. Broken promises become hostile witnesses.

Hall of Tribute

Every settlement's payment is displayed: names, teeth, bells, years, uniforms, children's drawings, unopened letters, harvest ledgers, and empty chairs.

Guest Wing

The Regent offers rest, food, baths, and conversation. Accepting hospitality grants real recovery but creates legal obligations.

Gallery of Roads

Maps show every path the party took, including the ones they never told anyone about.

Throne Chapel

The Regent's court assembles. Allies, enemies, servants, defectors, and the Bailiff may all appear depending on campaign choices.

Anchor-Undercroft

The final chamber beneath the throne. Here the party can break, seal, transform, or inherit the Anchor depending on Relics, choices, and cost.

The Regent

Run the Regent in phases:

1. **Courtly Predator** - conversation, accusation, invitation, and legal pressure.
2. **Sovereign Anchor** - battlefield control, summons, road/ledger/weather effects.
3. **Human Remnant** - the emotional truth beneath the monster, triggered by the Faded Family Photo, Ms. Park, a Claim contradiction, or a major sacrifice.

Endings

Break the Anchor

The Regent dies or collapses. The Gloamreach destabilizes. Escape becomes urgent.

Seal the Anchor

The Regent remains contained. The Gate closes or becomes unreachable, but something living remains inside.

Transform the Anchor

The Domain changes ruler or law. This is dangerous and campaign-defining.

Inherit the Anchor

A character or faction takes the throne. This should be treated as a dark ending unless earned through extraordinary sacrifice and restraint.

Warden Guidance

The finale should not ask only, "Can the party kill him?" It should ask, "What does victory cost when the land itself believes it belongs to him?"

Chapter 17: The Regent's Bailiff

The Regent's Bailiff

Overview

The Regent's Bailiff is not an escaped Anomaly and not a random roaming boss. It is a Domain officer created by the Regent's law. It enforces debt, invitation, tribute, custody, and judgment.

The Bailiff should feel like law enforcement from a nightmare: formal, patient, nearly unstoppable when its claim is valid, and strangely limited when the party understands the law it serves.

First Sighting

Read aloud:

You hear chains before you see the figure. Not dragged. Counted. Link by link, as if someone is measuring the road. A tall armored shape comes through the mist carrying a scroll in one hand and a hooked blade in the other. It stops at the milestone, unrolls the writ, and reads your names with perfect pronunciation.

Use at the Table

Before Level 8, the Bailiff is primarily a survival, negotiation, or contradiction encounter. The party can flee, hide, satisfy the charge, invalidate the charge, or force the Bailiff to withdraw by proving it lacks jurisdiction.

At higher levels, the party can fight it, but combat alone should not permanently solve the problem unless the law that summoned it has been broken or satisfied.

Suggested Stat Profile

Use an S-Rank Domain officer profile.

- High AC and HP.
- Immunity to fear, charm, poison, and mundane restraint.
- Resistance to damage while its legal charge is valid.
- Advantage when attacking a named target listed in its writ.
- Reduced defenses if the party proves the writ is false, paid, misnamed, or contradicted by a Claim.

Bailiff Charges

d8	Charge
1	Refused invitation twice.
2	Withheld tribute.

d8	Charge
3	Sheltered a condemned subject.
4	Traveled under a false name.
5	Stole property of the Regent's court.
6	Broke guest-right.
7	Interfered with lawful collection.
8	Carried a Claim without answering the throne.

Escape and Contradiction

The party may end a Bailiff scene without killing it by:

1. Paying or redirecting the debt.
2. Proving the writ names the wrong person.
3. Invoking guest-right.
4. Using a Claim to contradict the charge.
5. Forcing the Bailiff to read an older law from the Unseated Law.
6. Entering a sanctuary where the local law supersedes the Regent's writ for one scene.

Warden Guidance

The Bailiff is most frightening when it is correct. Let the party learn that survival depends on understanding the Domain, not only hitting harder.

Chapter 18: Side Quests of the Gloamreach

Side Quests of the Gloamreach

Overview

These quests replace old district errands with Domain-scale obligations. Each quest should reveal something about the Regent's law, the cost of survival, or the factions trying to control the outcome.

Quest 1: The Missing Strike Team

Giver: Commander Park **Objective:** Find Strike Team Seven inside the Gloamreach.

Steps:

1. Recover their first broken transmission near the Gate Threshold.
2. Follow AFA ghost-pings through the Road of Writs.
3. Find remains or survivors in Bastion Golemfal, the Sunken Tunnels, or the Citadel approach.
4. Decide whether to return the truth to the Bureau or hide what the team became.

Rewards: Bureau reputation, Ghost as a possible ally, and intelligence on the Regent's court.

Quest 2: Mother Rust's Breakthrough

Giver: Mother Rust **Objective:** Recover living mana from the Fungal Depths or Remembering Orchard.

Mother Rust can use it to treat Gate-Rot and Domain exposure, but the same compound can also suppress emotion and make people easier to move through grief-heavy terrain.

Rewards: Vermillion reputation, advanced healing, and possible Mother Rust alliance or corruption arc.

Quest 3: The Cult Defector

Giver: Whisper, Sister Veil, or Acolyte Mara **Objective:** Extract a defecting Awoko member from the Sanctum.

The defector knows the Hollow Mother intends to inherit the Domain, not liberate it. The cult will try to recover them alive because their grief has already been measured for ritual use.

Rewards: Awoko ritual intelligence, Bureau/Vermillion reputation, and a way to disrupt the Ritual of Inheritance.

Quest 4: Torch's Letter

Giver: Torch **Objective:** Get a letter out through the Bureau Annex relay.

This is a small human quest. Keep it small. That is why it matters.

Rewards: Torch as an ally, Vermillion reputation, and proof the party still cares about people beyond the main plot.

Quest 5: The Millwright's Device

Giver: The Millwright **Objective:** Build a one-use Domain suppression device.

Components:

1. One B-Rank core.
2. A schematic from Hayashi or Lun.
3. A gear-heart from the Tithe Mill.
4. A field test at a Mana Vein node.

Reward: one-use suppression of a local Domain law for one scene.

Quest 6: Mika's Prophecy

Giver: Mika the Kid **Objective:** Protect Mika and interpret her drawings.

Each drawing foreshadows a Claim, betrayal, Bailiff charge, settlement tribute, or Citadel chamber.

Reward: prophetic hints and final-act emotional leverage if Mika survives.

Quest 7: Iron Belle's Challenge

Giver: Iron Belle **Objective:** Win a nonlethal trial of strength, discipline, and restraint.

This should not be a throwaway fight. Iron Belle wants to know whether the party can stop before victory becomes cruelty.

Reward: Vermillion reputation, training, and Iron Belle's respect.

Quest 8: The Civilian Convoy

Giver: A settlement elder, Mother Rust, or Commander Park **Objective:** Escort civilians from a tribute settlement to safer shelter.

Complications:

- The road demands names.
- The Bailiff may challenge custody.
- Some civilians believe leaving voids the settlement's protection.

Rewards: civilian trust, Bureau or Vermillion reputation, and settlement support in the finale.

Quest 9: Acolyte Mara's Rescue

Giver: Sister Veil **Objective:** Rescue Mara from the Awoko before she is used as ritual fuel.

Reward: Mara and Sister Veil as allies, ritual disruption, and proof that cultists can still be saved.

Quest 10: Ghost's Memory

Giver: Ghost **Objective:** Restore Ghost's identity without handing them back to Bureau custody as evidence.

Ghost's memories are hidden across dead-team markers, the Drowned Ledgerfen, and a Claim-touched item.

Reward: Ghost restored as a high-rank ally and classified intelligence about the Regent.

Quest 11: Professor Lun's Theory

Giver: Professor Lun **Objective:** Place sensors at three Mana Vein nodes.

Reward: weakened Regent Domain control during the finale.

Quest 12: Rat-King Ji's Stash

Giver: Rat-King Ji **Objective:** Recover a hidden stash before the Road of Writs legally transfers it to someone else.

Reward: contraband, Claim clue, or a dangerous shortcut.

Warden Guidance

Every side quest should sharpen the central question: what does survival cost when the land itself has laws?

Chapter 19: Domain Pressure Encounters

Domain Pressure Encounters

Overview

Use these encounters when the Gloamreach needs to push back without derailing the party's current objective.

Pressure Types

Legal Pressure

A writ, toll, invitation, accusation, or custody claim appears. This pressure teaches players that law is a monster here.

Environmental Pressure

Weather changes, food spoils, the road moves, shelter becomes conditional, or a settlement bell rings.

Social Pressure

A faction demands a decision. Civilians ask for help. Vermillion calls in a favor. Bureau orders contradict morality. Awoko comfort feels too useful.

Predatory Pressure

A hunter, Bailiff servant, umbral scout, adaptive beast, or cult cell tracks the party.

Encounter Rule

Every pressure encounter should reveal at least one of the following:

1. A Domain law.
2. A settlement lie.
3. A faction cost.
4. A Claim clue.
5. A future consequence.

Chapter 20: Recruitable Allies

Recruitable Allies

Overview

Allies should never be simple stat blocks. Each one represents a possible answer to the Gloamreach.

Ally Categories

Bureau Allies

Disciplined, supplied, and politically constrained. They help with logistics, research, and final-operation support.

Vermillion Allies

Fast, practical, and morally flexible. They help with salvage, black-market access, shelter, and unconventional solutions.

Civilian Allies

Vulnerable but narratively powerful. They create stakes, rumors, shelter, and emotional leverage.

Awoko Defectors

Dangerous because they know the cult's rituals and have already been shaped by grief. Saving them should matter.

Domain-Born Allies

Rare and unstable. A spirit commander, changed survivor, or oathbound guardian may help if the party proves they do not intend to become new tyrants.

Final-Act Use

Allies should affect the Citadel by opening paths, blocking reinforcements, delaying the Bailiff, protecting civilians, revealing a law, or creating a human moment with the Regent.

Chapter 21: Regent Relics and Claim Consequences

Regent Relics and Claim Consequences

Overview

The Three Claims are the primary campaign Relics, but lesser Regent-touched items may appear throughout the Gloamreach.

Relic Principles

1. A Regent Relic is never only powerful. It is legal evidence.
2. Using one should attract attention.
3. Carrying one may change road behavior.
4. Relics can contradict Domain law, but they can also teach the Regent how the party thinks.

Lesser Relic Examples

Writ-Knife

Cuts written contracts. Cannot cut flesh unless the target has broken an oath.

Guest-Ring

Grants safe shelter once, but creates a debt of hospitality.

Toll Lantern

Reveals the true length of a road. Each use ages the flame-bearer's shadow.

Ledger Hook

Pulls one hidden name from a document. The document then learns one name from the wielder.

Claim Consequences

When the party recovers a Claim, choose one pressure response:

1. The Regent sends a polite invitation.
2. The Bailiff receives a new charge.
3. A settlement's tribute changes.
4. The Awoko attempt theft or corruption.
5. The Road of Writs shortens, but only toward danger.

Chapter 22: Treasure and Rewards

Treasure and Rewards

Overview

Rewards in the Gloamreach should feel useful, costly, and story-facing. Credits matter less when the road demands things money cannot buy.

Reward Categories

Cores

Still valuable to Bureau and Vermillion. Use cores for gear, research, medicine, and faction favors.

Relics

Tie Relics to Domain laws. Even minor Relics should imply ownership, debt, hospitality, memory, or survival.

Sigils and Runes

Use Chapter 34 for tier guidance. Let factions offer different routes to similar power with different consequences.

Safe Shelter

A safe long rest can be more valuable than money. Make shelter a reward, not an assumption.

Names and Truths

The right name, charge, confession, or precedent may defeat something combat cannot.

Final Rewards

After the campaign, rewards depend on the ending.

- Break the Anchor: powerful fragments, unstable Domain collapse, urgent escape.
- Seal the Anchor: fewer material rewards, greater moral victory, possible future return.
- Transform the Anchor: altered Domain, new laws, uncertain consequences.
- Inherit the Anchor: great power, dark cost, sequel hook.

Chapter 23: Warden's Horror Guide

Warden's Horror Guide

Intended Rating

Mature Dark Fantasy Gate Horror.

Use oppressive dread, psychological horror, body horror, starvation, tribute, institutional abandonment, corpse imagery, cursed hospitality, predatory nobility, forced moral compromise, transformation horror, and Domain-law violation.

Do not use sexual violence, eroticized harm, real-world hate ideology, cruelty to children as spectacle, or torture-porn framing.

Horror Pillars

Ownership

The Regent's horror is ownership. The land, roads, ledgers, invitations, servants, and even safe rooms suggest the party is already claimed.

Hospitality

Meals, beds, guest-right, and courtesy should feel comforting and dangerous at the same time.

Bureau Failure

The Bureau is not useless. It is insufficient. Let the party feel the gap between protocol and reality.

Survival Compromise

Settlements survive by doing things they cannot emotionally survive doing forever.

The Human Remnant (the Domain's Costume)

The Regent was never human — but the Domain curates "evidence" that he was and offers it to the party as bait. Do not use that to excuse him. Use the lie to make the final confrontation hurt: the mercy the party reaches for was manufactured to be reached for.

Pacing Advice

Alternate pressure and breath. Horror needs contrast. A hot meal before a terrible choice will do more damage than constant screaming.

Warden North Star

Before every major scene, answer four questions:

1. What law is operating here?

2. What lie makes it survivable?
3. What tribute keeps it stable?
4. What happens if the party refuses?

Chapter 24: Oracle Reading - The Fortune of the Domain

Oracle Reading - The Fortune of the Domain

| *A Domain does not hide its secrets. It files them under your name and waits for you to sign.*

Purpose

This chapter replaces older fortune systems tied to city districts or unrelated Gates. The Oracle Reading determines where the Three Claims are hidden, who can become the party's strongest ally, who becomes a final-act betrayer, and where the Regent's authority can be contradicted.

Perform the reading once per campaign. The results are permanent.

The Reader

The reading may be performed by Sister Constance, a retired Oracle living near the Bureau cordon, or by a broken oracle engine recovered just inside the Gate Threshold. Either version should feel unreliable, exhausted, and frightened of accuracy.

Read aloud:

Five cards lie on the table. They are black glass, warm at the edges, cold in the center. The reader does not ask your question. She looks at the Gate beyond the window and says, "It already knows what you came to ask."

The Five Card Spread

Card 1 - The Spark

This card reveals where one Ascendant can undergo a second Awakening. The location should be inside the Gloamreach or just at the threshold. The gift always has a cost: a memory, a favor, a wound, a name, a promise, or a debt to a faction.

Card 2 - The Chain

This card reveals the location of the first Claim, traditionally tied to the Relic of the Void. It weakens the Regent's ability to hide truth, erase routes, or smother light.

Card 3 - The Crown

This card reveals the location of the second Claim, traditionally tied to the Relic of the Abyss. It weakens the Regent's command over roads, invitations, and forced obedience.

Card 4 - The Pulse

This card reveals the location of the third Claim, traditionally tied to the Relic of Blood. It weakens the Regent's ability to make the Domain treat people as property.

Card 5 - The Oathbreaker

This card identifies the ally, faction agent, or settlement leader most likely to betray the party in the final act. The betrayal should not be random. It should be caused by fear, tribute, blackmail, hunger, grief, or a bargain with the Regent's court.

Domain Location Table

Use these locations as the default result set:

1. The Gate Threshold.
2. The Road of Writs.
3. The Tithe Mill.
4. The Predator Woods.
5. The Drowned Ledgerfen.
6. The Remembering Orchard.
7. Bastion Golemfall.
8. The Vermillion Outpost.
9. The Forbidden Vault of the Unseated Law.
10. The Regent's Citadel.

Warden Guidance

This reading is the campaign's structural spine. It should create the same practical function as a classic gothic artifact reading: the party receives direction without losing sandbox freedom. The reading should make the Domain feel fated, but not scripted.

Chapter 25: Ascendant Hooks - Reasons to Enter the Gloamreach

Ascendant Hooks - Reasons to Enter the Gloamreach

Purpose

Every character needs a reason to cross the S-Rank threshold and keep moving after escape becomes uncertain. These hooks replace older district-crisis assumptions and tie the party directly to the Gloamreach.

Personal Hooks

The Contract

The character signed a Bureau or Guild contract before the Domain classification was confirmed. Backing out now would ruin them financially, legally, or politically.

The Missing Team

Someone the character knows entered during the first response wave. Their AFA tag still pings from somewhere inside the Gloamreach, always farther down the road.

The Name in the Ledger

The character's name appears in a Regent ledger recovered before the campaign begins. No one knows who wrote it.

The Survivor's Debt

The character survived a previous Gate because someone else stayed behind. The Gloamreach contains that person's voice, echo, body, or unpaid sentence.

The Relic Claim

A Relic bonded to the character reacts violently when the Gate opens. It is not calling them to power. It is recognizing jurisdiction.

The Veteran of a Failed Clear

The character has seen a Gate stop behaving like a place and start behaving like a ruler. They know the Bureau briefing is too clean.

Group Hooks

1. The Bureau hires the party because higher-rank teams vanished inside.

2. Vermillion offers illegal support if the party agrees to recover salvage and survivors.
3. A settlement inside the Domain sends a written invitation that appears in the material world.
4. A dead Ascendant's AFA broadcasts from the Regent's Citadel every night at the same time.
5. The Gate enters a Red Phase countdown, forcing immediate entry.

Warden Guidance

The best hook is not glory. It is obligation. The Gloamreach should feel like a place the party enters because no better option exists, then survives because leaving would abandon too many people to the Regent's law.

Chapter 26: Stat Blocks Appendix - Domain Use Notes

Stat Blocks Appendix - Domain Use Notes

Purpose

This appendix gives Warden-facing guidance for using stat blocks inside the Gloamreach. Full stat blocks should remain in their source compendium files where possible. This chapter explains how to frame them in the Domain.

Regent-Aligned Creatures

A Regent-aligned creature should feel like an extension of law, not a random encounter. Give each one a purpose.

Examples:

1. Tax collectors recover unpaid tribute.
2. Road wardens punish trespass.
3. Hounds follow names, not scent.
4. Mirror-things deliver invitations.
5. Bailiff-servants enforce judgments.

The Regent's Bailiff

Use the Regent's Bailiff as a recurring Domain officer. It does not need to be fought every time it appears. It can announce charges, deliver summons, take custody of NPCs, demand tribute, or mark a settlement for punishment.

The Bailiff should be difficult to kill permanently unless the party breaks the law that summoned it.

The Unseated Law

The Unseated Law has no normal stat block. If the party confronts it, run the scene as a trial, bargain, memory excavation, or legal contradiction. Combat should occur only through guardians, precedent-echoes, or failed petitioners.

Horror Encounter Rules

1. Every combat should reveal something about the Domain.
2. Every victory should cost time, supplies, reputation, safety, or certainty.
3. Intelligent enemies should know the local law better than the party.
4. Monsters should not merely attack. They should enforce, collect, witness, punish, or invite.

Scaling

For low-level parties, reduce damage but preserve consequences. For high-level parties, increase legal pressure before increasing hit points. The Gloamreach is frightening because it changes what victory means.

Chapter 27: Artifacts and Claims Cross-Reference

Artifacts and Claims Cross-Reference

| *An artifact is a promise with enough power to outlive the person who made it. - Dr. Serin Hayashi*

Using This Chapter

This chapter maps named items, Relics, Sigils, Runes, tattoos, and narrative props to their place in **The Shadow of the Regent**. Full mechanical entries remain in the authoritative compendium files. This chapter exists to keep the Gloamreach module aligned with the item economy without duplicating stat blocks.

The Three Claims

The Three Claims are the campaign's primary Relic structure. They are legal contradictions in the Regent's ownership of the Gloamreach.

Claim	Function	Typical Placement
Void Claim	Contradicts secrecy, erasure, false darkness, and hidden roads.	Hollow Subway, Drowned Ledgerfen, Fungal Depths, Obsidian Spire.
Abyss Claim	Contradicts command, invitation, forced movement, and road authority.	Ashen Counting-House, Bastion Golemfal, Forbidden Vault, Citadel.
Blood Claim	Contradicts ownership of bodies, tribute, inheritance, and sacrifice.	Remembering Orchard, Sunken Tunnels, Tithe Mill, Awoko Sanctum.

The Oracle Reading in Chapter 24 determines actual placement.

Finale Artifact Slate

When the Anchor is resolved, choose rewards according to the ending and party composition.

Break the Anchor

The Regent's Anchor-throne fractures violently. The party may recover high-power fragments, but the Domain begins collapsing.

Recommended drops: Regent's Edge, Regent's Shadow Dagger, Shadow Regent's Mantle, or a damage-focused S-tier Rune.

Seal the Anchor

The Regent remains contained. The party receives fewer destructive rewards, but may earn a stabilizing Relic, a protective Sigil, or a memorial item that matters in future campaigns.

Recommended drops: Architect's Authority, Sovereign Aegis, Undying Flame Sigil, or a protective S-tier Rune.

Transform the Anchor

The Domain changes its ruling law. Rewards should be strange, conditional, and tied to the new law.

Recommended drops: Origin Reliquary, World-ENDER Reliquary, or a custom Claim evolution.

Inherit the Anchor

A character or faction claims the throne. Treat this as a dark or ambiguous ending unless extraordinary sacrifice and restraint make it otherwise.

Recommended reward: authority, not loot. The character gains power and becomes responsible for the Domain's hunger.

Sigil Drops by Domain Site

Domain Site	Sigil Guidance
Hollow Subway	Aegis, Grounded Soul, or mobility Sigil.
Drowned Ledgerfen	Frost-Ward, Iron Mind, or truth/diagnosis-themed protection.
Fungal Depths	Cleansed Blood or poison/rot resistance.
Remembering Orchard	Zephyr's Tread, Silent Guardian, or Sense/memory support.
Ashen Counting-House	Crimson Weeping, Hearth-Fire, or debt/blood Sigil.
Sunken Tunnels	Winter Court, Hearth-Fire, or underwater survival support.
Bastion Golemfall	Unmoving Stone, Dragon's Scale, or shield/armor Sigil.
Obsidian Spire	Void-Walker, Shadow Regent, Grandmaster's Edge.
Regent's Citadel	Undying Flame, Sovereign's Will, or S-tier finale reward.

Tattoos and Downtime Rewards

The Vermillion Outpost can provide tattoos from `tattoos.ts` at Trusted reputation. Tattoos should be offered as survival tools, identity marks, or body-horror-adjacent choices. The Gloamreach should make body modification feel powerful but intimate.

Runes

Use Chapter 34 for Rune tier placement. Runes should be scarce and story-facing. A Rune found in the Gloamreach should imply a prior owner, a cost, or a law it once served.

Campaign-Unique Narrative Props

The Faded Family Photo

Recovered in Day Zero or found in the Citadel. It is the most important emotional prop in the campaign. It proves the Regent had a human life before becoming Anchor.

Ms. Park's Wedding Ring

Optional if Ms. Park survived. It can create a final moment of hesitation, recognition, or grief in the Regent's human-remnant phase.

The Visitors' Log

A local object from the Memory-Care Wing. Names written in it foreshadow how dangerous ledgers become inside the Gloamreach.

The Unopened Commendation

Found in the Citadel. It is addressed to a name that reality can no longer preserve.

The Child's Toy

A Citadel prop from the Regent's erased human past. It should be emotionally useful, not mechanically powerful.

The Diploma

A final proof that the Regent had a legal identity before the Domain consumed it.

Warden Guidance

Artifacts in this campaign should not feel like treasure alone. They are evidence, leverage, temptation, and memory. The best item is one the party wants to use and fears using.

Chapter 28: The Regent's Citadel - Castle Dungeon

The Regent's Citadel - Castle Dungeon

The castle does not stand at the end of the road. The road is the castle reaching for you.

Overview

The Regent's Citadel is the final castle-scale dungeon of the campaign. It should evoke the same practical footprint as a gothic horror castle: multiple routes, social pressure, hostile rooms, secrets, invitations, old grief, servants, traps, and a final throne/Anchor confrontation.

The Citadel is visible from almost everywhere in the Gloamreach, but reaching it requires the party to survive roads, laws, claims, faction consequences, and the Regent's personal attention.

Approach

Before the party reaches the gates, resolve the following:

1. Which factions support the party?
2. Which settlements owe the party trust or blame?
3. Which Claims do they carry?
4. Which invitations have they accepted or refused?
5. Has the Bailiff been defeated, delayed, satisfied, or empowered?
6. Has the Hollow Mother's ritual been disrupted?

Citadel Regions

1. The Road of Final Writs

The last road names each character. The party can erase, contradict, or accept the names. Accepting creates advantage on social entry checks but gives the Regent legal leverage.

2. Outer Gate

The gate opens for invitation, tribute, force, or contradiction. If the party has no valid path, the Bailiff appears to announce charges.

3. The Courtyard of Collected Banners

Banners from conquered settlements hang in rainless wind. Each saved settlement may cause one banner to fall, weakening a Citadel defense.

4. The Hall of Tribute

Names, teeth, bells, harvest ledgers, uniforms, children's drawings, unopened letters, and empty chairs are displayed as tribute.

A character who studies the hall may learn one truth about a settlement's tribute. Doing so risks psychic strain.

5. Guest Wing

The Regent offers food, rest, baths, medical care, and conversation. The recovery is real. So is the debt.

If the party rests here, they regain resources, but each character must answer one question truthfully or accept one hospitality mark.

6. Gallery of Roads

Maps show every route the party took, including choices they hid from allies. The Gallery can reveal shortcuts, betrayals, and the location of a missed Claim.

7. The Bureau Room

A modern office preserved — impossibly — inside the Citadel (a Xylo archive that should not exist). It contains the Unopened Commendation, fragments of Bureau history the Domain has no honest way of possessing, and curated "evidence" that the Regent was once human. None of it is true; all of it is bait, assembled from the echoes of the claimed.

8. The Orchard Room

A quiet chamber with black-barked trees and memory fruit. Eating a fruit can restore one lost clue or inflict one painful truth.

9. The Nursery of Empty Titles

Armor, uniforms, crowns, badges, and nameplates wait for owners. This room tempts characters who want authority.

10. The Bailiff's Stair

A spiral stair lined with hooks and scrolls. If the Bailiff still has active authority, it confronts the party here. If legally defeated earlier, its armor hangs empty.

11. The Awoko Breach

If the Hollow Mother's ritual remains active, cultists breach the Citadel here, trying to reach the Anchor while the party weakens the Regent.

12. The Forbidden Descent

A stair leading below the Citadel toward the Unseated Law. Taking this route can provide a final bargain or contradiction, but it costs time and may alter the ending.

13. The Chapel of Guest-Right

A beautiful room where every act of hospitality in the campaign is remembered. Betrayed guest-right becomes hostile. Honored guest-right becomes protection.

14. The Throne Court

The Regent receives the party before witnesses: allies, enemies, servants, settlement representatives, shadows, and possibly the human remnants of his past.

This scene should begin with words, not initiative.

15. The Anchor-Undercroft

The final chamber beneath the throne. The Anchor is not a crystal to smash. It is a legal/metaphysical structure of ownership, memory, grief, tribute, and will.

Final Confrontation Phases

Phase 1 - Courtly Predator

The Regent debates, accuses, tempts, and offers terms. The party can gain advantages by using truths, Claims, allies, and contradictions.

Phase 2 - Sovereign Anchor

The Regent fights as the Domain's ruler. Use lair actions tied to roads, weather, ledgers, hospitality, and shadows.

Phase 3 - Human Remnant

Triggered by the Faded Family Photo, Ms. Park, a successful Claim contradiction, the Wedding Ring, or a major sacrifice. The party sees the human grief underneath the Regent's monstrosity.

This phase does not make him innocent. It makes the ending harder.

Possible Endings

Break

Destroy the Anchor and escape the collapsing Domain.

Seal

Contain the Regent and close the Gate without destroying everything inside.

Transform

Change the Domain's ruling law. Dangerous, rare, and campaign-defining.

Inherit

A character or faction takes the throne. Treat this as a dark victory unless earned with exceptional restraint.

Warden Guidance

The Citadel should be frightening because it knows the campaign. Bring back choices, meals, names, lies, saved NPCs, abandoned NPCs, unpaid debts, and old kindnesses. The final dungeon is not a place the

party visits. It is the campaign looking back at them.

Chapter 29: Bureau Domain Response Annex - Keyed Rooms

Bureau Domain Response Annex - Keyed Rooms

A Bureau is a wall people build after learning that prayer alone does not stop teeth. - Commander Park Jae-won

Overview

The **Bureau Domain Response Annex** is the material-side operations base outside the S-Rank Gate. It is not the center of the campaign. It is the last clean line before the Gloamreach.

Use the Annex as a briefing hub, medical station, research site, faction-pressure point, and reminder that the modern world still exists beyond the threshold. The Annex should feel professional, exhausted, underinformed, and one bad report away from panic.

Room 1 - Barricade Lobby and Solara Shrine

Floodlights, concrete barriers, scanners, and a line of wounded civilians waiting behind plastic sheeting. In one corner, someone has placed a small sun-bronze sparrow under a cracked glass dome.

Services:

- Ascendant clearance check-in.
- Updated Gate Domain warnings.
- Bureau Emergency Bulletin handout.
- One small shrine blessing per campaign: a character who leaves a sincere token may reroll one failed save against a Regent-aligned effect.

Room 2 - Relay and Dispatch

Twelve monitors show shifting telemetry from the Gloamreach. The maps do not agree. Some messages arrive before they were sent.

Services:

- Send one material-side message per day while the Annex remains functional.
- Review missing-team telemetry.
- Reconstruct broken transmissions from Strike Team Seven.

Investigation: DC 15 Investigation reveals that at least one response team reported seeing the Regent's Citadel before any official map confirmed it existed.

Room 3 - Briefing Hall

Whiteboards, projected maps, coffee rings, and hand-drawn roads copied from survivor testimony. Commander Park briefs the party here.

Services:

- Mission assignments.
- Reputation updates.
- Tactical debriefs.
- Training drills at Allied Bureau reputation.

Room 4 - Armory

A reinforced vault of Bureau gear. Nothing here is glamorous. Everything here is useful.

Services:

- Mana rations, glow rods, smoke grenades, first-aid kits.
- Standard weapons and tactical armor.
- One rare-or-lower requisition at Allied reputation.

Blackwood Hook: a locked footlocker may contain pre-threshold Relic evidence if the Oracle Reading placed one Claim near the material side.

Room 5 - Evidence Locker and Anomaly Vault

Confiscated cores, cult pamphlets, failed Relics, sealed tissue samples, and a cold workbench where Dr. Hayashi writes the reports no one wants to read.

Services:

- Core appraisal.
- Relic analysis.
- Regent Domain research.
- Autopsy reports from Domain-touched creatures.

Hayashi can provide the party with the **Research Brief: Regent Domains** handout at Trusted reputation.

Room 6 - Morgue and Echo Room

Twelve drawers. Too many occupied. Behind an unmarked door, the Echo Room preserves fragments of last memories in mana-saline.

Use this room to show the cost of the Domain's appetite. It can surface final words the Gloamreach has kept from those it claimed, confirm Regent-Marked symptoms, or plant the Domain's bait — the first curated hint that the Regent was "once human" (he was not).

Room 7 - Commander Park's Office

A quiet glass-walled office facing the Gate floodlights. Park keeps old team photos, unsent letters, and political orders he does not intend to obey if civilians are at stake.

Services:

- Bureau commendations.
- Council leverage at Allied reputation.
- Confession scenes once the party proves they can handle ugly truths.

Room 8 - Holding Cells

Three reinforced cells for cult prisoners, Domain-touched civilians, and people the Bureau cannot classify cleanly.

Use this room to complicate the party's morality. A prisoner may be dangerous, innocent, infected, lying, terrified, or all of those at once.

Room 9 - Relic Exam Room

Professor Lun studies Relics, Sigils, and Claim-resonance here. He is not a god, prophet, or secret villain. He is an expert who knows enough to be afraid.

Services:

- Relic identification.
- Sigil appraisal.
- Rune decoding.
- Claim resonance testing.

Room 10 - Roof Heliport and Drone Pad

The roof carries drones, VTOL craft, storm tarps, and the constant vibration of the S-Rank Gate. It is used for rapid cordon movement, emergency extraction near the threshold, and the final material-side relay before the party enters the Citadel approach.

Bureau Reputation Milestones

Reputation	Unlock
Neutral	Basic services, no free gear beyond emergency kit.
Friendly	Mana rations, Hayashi's briefing, limited safe rest.
Trusted	Relic analysis, Park's private files, special requisitions.
Allied	Council leverage, rare gear, final-operation support.

Warden Guidance

The Annex is safety with a countdown. Keep it useful, but never let it feel permanent. Every return from the Gloamreach should show more strain: more wounded, worse maps, fewer drones, quieter staff, and a Gate that looks a little more like a mouth.

Chapter 30: Vermillion Outpost - Keyed Rooms

Vermillion Outpost - Keyed Rooms

| *Survive first. Obey later. - Vermillion Guild field motto*

Overview

The **Vermillion Outpost** is a black-market shelter inside the Gloamreach. It exists because Vermillion crossed early, moved fast, bribed the right people, and accepted costs the Bureau would still be debating. The outpost is warm, loud, practical, morally stained, and full of people who owe someone something.

Room 1 - Bazaar Front

Crates, lanterns, tarps, field stoves, core scales, and people arguing over salvage rights. Rat-King Ji brokers information here.

Services:

- Buy and sell Anomaly cores.
- Purchase illegal consumables.
- Trade rumors about roads, settlements, and Claim locations.

Room 2 - Orin's Chamber

A plain room with maps, tea, and a weapon Orin rarely touches. He knows the Bureau is necessary. He also knows it is often too slow.

Services:

- Guild induction.
- Faction arbitration.
- Regent combat notes at Trusted reputation.

Room 3 - Black Market

A mana-muffled back room. The broker has no name and changes masks every time the party visits.

Services:

- Gray-market gear.
- Restricted Runes.
- Identity laundering.
- False travel papers for settlements that check writs.

Room 4 - Tattoo Parlour

Bright's ink parlor turns scars, songs, and mana into functional tattoos. The work is beautiful because beauty is one of the few things the Regent does not get to own for free.

Services:

- Canonical tattoos.
- Tattoo voucher redemption.
- Tattoo removal at high cost.

Room 5 - Sigil Parlour

Sigilmaster Baek engraves weapons, armor, and accessories. He works slowly, and nothing he makes is casual.

Services:

- Weapon sigils.
- Armor sigils.
- Accessory sigils.
- Legendary-tier work only at Allied reputation.

Room 6 - Field Kitchen

Food is power inside the Gloamreach. A hot meal grants 1d4 temporary HP for one hour, but food has to come from somewhere.

Warden pressure: if the party eats free too often, show who goes without.

Room 7 - Clinic and Backroom Surgery

Mother Rust treats the wounded. She is kind until kindness becomes inefficient. Her clinic can save people the Bureau would classify as lost causes.

Services:

- Healing.
- Condition treatment.
- Illegal augmentation.
- Trauma recovery scenes.

Room 8 - Bounty Board

Bounties include missing teams, dangerous roads, toll-house sabotage, Domain beasts, settlement relief, Claim clues, and Awoko ritual sites.

Room 9 - Smuggler Gate

A hidden exit that does not always open to the same place. Vermillion uses it to move goods around Regent patrols. Each use risks debt to the road.

Room 10 - The Quiet Room

A warded room where no one bargains, recruits, sells, or threatens. It exists because Orin believes people need one place where survival is not being monetized.

Use this room for character scenes, grief, confession, and hard choices.

Vermillion Reputation Milestones

Reputation	Unlock
Neutral	Basic trade.
Friendly	Better prices, rumor access, limited shelter.
Trusted	Black-market services, tattoos, special bounties.
Allied	Orin's direct support, outpost defenders in the finale, deep Claim intelligence.

Warden Guidance

Vermillion should never be purely heroic or purely criminal. They are what happens when people decide bureaucracy is too slow and morality is too expensive. Make their help real. Make the bill real too.

Chapter 31: Tribute Settlements - Keyed Locations

Tribute Settlements - Keyed Locations

The Regent does not need every village to love him. He only needs them to keep paying.

Overview

The Gloamreach contains settlements that survive by compromise. None are safe for free. Each location has a law, a lie, a tribute, and a failure state.

Location 1 - Mother Rust's Outreach Post

A clinic built in the second floor of a leaning tenement that should not still be standing. Mother Rust treats the sick, the Gate-touched, and those the Bureau would classify as unrecoverable.

Law: Mercy must be paid forward. Lie: Care is free. Tribute: Medicine, cores, favors, or silence. Failure: The clinic starts deciding who is worth saving.

Services:

- Treat Gate-Rot and minor Domain conditions.
- Civilian aftercare.
- Rumors about Awoko recruiters.
- Recovery scenes after major horror encounters.

If Ms. Park survived Day Zero, she may be here under Mother Rust's care.

Location 2 - The Covered Market

A neutral market under patched canvas and rusted tin. Bureau scouts, Vermillion runners, settlement traders, smugglers, and cult watchers all pass through.

Law: No violence while the bell hangs. Lie: Neutrality protects everyone. Tribute: One secret per stall per week. Failure: The bell falls, and every unpaid secret becomes public.

Services:

- Rumors.
- Food.
- Salvage.
- Stolen maps.
- Questionable guides.

Location 3 - The Writ-Bound Hamlet

A village where every door has a paper writ nailed above it. The residents speak politely and never refuse invitations aloud.

Law: No one may refuse a written invitation twice. Lie: Courtesy keeps them safe. Tribute: One household hosts a Regent servant each week. Failure: The Bailiff comes at dawn.

Use this settlement to teach the danger of hospitality.

Location 4 - The Bellweather School

A schoolhouse converted into a shelter. Children draw places they have never seen. The bell rings when the Road of Writs changes.

Law: Children may not be taken if someone else answers the bell. Lie: The adults always know who should answer. Tribute: Volunteers stand at the road when the bell rings. Failure: The road chooses instead.

Mika the Kid can appear here. Her drawings foreshadow the Citadel, the Bailiff, and the Three Claims.

Location 5 - Old Man Crane's Teahouse

A quiet teahouse that appears at crossroads. It is always the same room, no matter where the door stands.

Law: Tea must be finished before violence. Lie: Crane is only an old man. Tribute: A true story from each guest. Failure: The story repeats later with worse actors.

Old Man Crane can teach the party about sealing a Regent instead of destroying one, but his method costs more than technique.

Location 6 - The Empty Mill Village

A settlement whose residents leave food on every table and sleep in locked barns. No one will explain why.

Law: The mill must turn by moonrise. Lie: Grain is what the mill grinds. Tribute: Names written on husks and fed into the stones. Failure: The mill grinds bodies instead.

This is an ideal location for a Claim clue or a Bailiff arrival.

Settlement-Wide Systems

Civilian Trust

Track how many settlements the party protects, exploits, abandons, or liberates. Civilian trust affects final-act support, rumors, safe rests, and whether common people will resist the Regent's court.

Shrines

Small shrines appear throughout settlements. Some are sincere. Some are bait.

- Solara: one reroll against fear or despair.
- Vaelen: advantage on one trial or combat-opening save.
- Lyra: temporary HP and mutation risk.
- Cipher: advantage on a Sense check involving memory or truth.

- Marthos: never free. Always a trap, a rot, or a mercy with teeth.

Chapter 32: Mana Vein Network and the Third Node

Mana Vein Network and the Third Node

A Gate Domain is not only a place. It is a pressure system with laws pretending to be weather. - Dr. Serin Hayashi

Overview

The Gloamreach is threaded with Mana Veins: deep channels of Essence pressure that stabilize roads, settlements, Relics, and Anchor law. Professor Lun believes that mapping or disrupting enough nodes can weaken the Regent's battlefield control during the finale.

The veins are inside the Domain.

Node 1 - The Rusted Hull

A dry-docked ship half-buried in black soil far from any sea. A vein pulses beneath the keel.

Challenge: Install a sensor while avoiding a Beast swarm feeding on overflow Essence. Reward: Access to one movement-related Sigil or a road shortcut.

Node 2 - The Silent Depot

A train station with no tracks and announcements for dead passengers. A vein runs through the old signal room.

Challenge: Umbral scouts guard the signal levers. Reward: One B-Rank Rune or a clue about the Road of Writs.

Node 3 - The Glass Sub-Basement

A buried financial archive beneath the Ashen Counting-House. It contains the deepest active vein outside the Citadel.

SB-1 - Security Checkpoint

Bureau equipment sits abandoned beside Domain-made badges. The checkpoint recognizes authority but not identity.

SB-2 - Vein Engine

A glass cylinder contains a pulsing channel of Essence. Installing Lun's sensor requires a DC 15 Intelligence check. On failure, the sensor works, but the Regent learns who placed it.

SB-3 - The Precedent Echo

A legal echo from the Unseated Law asks the party to define ownership. The answer determines whether the node weakens the Regent, the road, or the party's own legal protections.

Finale Effect

If the party activates all three nodes, the Regent begins the final confrontation with weakened Domain control. Choose one:

1. The Regent loses one lair action for the first three rounds.
2. The party may cancel one forced movement effect.
3. The Road of Writs cannot separate the party during the Citadel approach.

Warden Guidance

Mana Veins should not feel like power generators. They are nerves. When the party touches one, the Domain feels it.

Chapter 33: The Awoko Sanctum

The Awoko Sanctum

Overview

The Awoko Sanctum is hidden in a grief-dense fold of the Gloamreach: a chapel, clinic, theater, and execution room all occupying the same impossible floor plan. The Awoko do not see themselves as villains. That makes them more dangerous.

They preach that the Regent is proof humanity can transcend Rank, death, and Bureau ownership. Their real leadership intends to inherit the Domain.

Core Truth

The Hollow Mother does not serve the Regent. She intends to replace him.

Sanctum Law

Law: Grief may be converted into authority. **Lie:** The cult helps people remember. **Tribute:** Loss, confession, blood, and obedience. **Failure:** The grieving become fuel.

Key Areas

S-1 - Nave of Remembered Names

Thousands of names hang from threads. Some are dead. Some are alive. Some belong to the party if they have been careless with ledgers.

S-2 - Confession Chamber

Initiates confess grief into speaking tubes. The grief is stored, refined, and used to power rituals.

S-3 - Clinic of Gentle Hands

The cult offers real comfort here. Do not make it fake. The danger is that the comfort is being weaponized.

S-4 - Choir Pit

Idol-class cultists sing Domain law into a more obedient shape. Interrupting the choir can delay a Regent court event or weaken Hollow Mother's ritual.

S-5 - Sister Veil's Laboratory

Sister Veil knows the ritual math is wrong. She can defect if shown evidence that the Hollow Mother intends to use the cult as fuel.

S-6 - The Ritual of Inheritance

A circular chamber with seven candle-stations, each burning with grief-tallow. If completed, the ritual lets the Hollow Mother attempt to inherit the Regent's claim.

Major NPCs

The Hollow Mother

Charismatic, grieving, brilliant, and predatory. She speaks softly. She never says serve when inherit will do.

Sister Veil

Ritualist and possible defector. She is guilty, but not unreachable.

Acolyte Mara

A young initiate who can become a human face for the cult's victims.

Ritual Disruption

The party can disrupt the ritual by:

1. Destroying one correct candle-station.
2. Convincing Sister Veil to corrupt the final chant.
3. Removing the stored grief from the Confession Chamber.
4. Presenting proof that the Hollow Mother intends to inherit, not liberate.

Warden Guidance

The Awoko should be horrifying because they understand pain and exploit it with tenderness. Push the dread, not caricature. Their kindness should make the party angrier, not less afraid.

Chapter 34: Runes Cross-Reference

Runes Cross-Reference

| *A rune is a spell that stopped moving. That is not a metaphor. - Professor Lun*

Using This Chapter

Runes in *The Shadow of the Regent* come from canonical compendium sources. This chapter does not restate them. It maps where rune tiers appear inside the Gloamreach so the Warden can prep rewards without drifting from core canon.

Canonical sources:

- `runes/spell-rank-d.ts`
- `runes/spell-rank-c.ts`
- `runes/spell-rank-b.ts`
- `runes/spell-rank-a.ts`
- `runes/spell-rank-s.ts`
- `runes/technique-techniques.ts`
- `runes/power-powers.ts`

Rune Drop Schedule

Tier	Domain Source	Canonical Source
D	The Hollow Subway, Drowned Ledgerfen, early road encounters	<code>runes/spell-rank-d.ts</code>
C	Fungal Depths, Remembering Orchard, Ashen Counting-House	<code>runes/spell-rank-c.ts</code>
B	Sunken Tunnels, Bastion Golemfall, Mana Vein Node rewards	<code>runes/spell-rank-b.ts</code>
A	Obsidian Spire, Forbidden Vault, Citadel approach, Hayashi research trade	<code>runes/spell-rank-a.ts</code>
S	Regent's Anchor-throne fragments after the finale	<code>runes/spell-rank-s.ts</code>
Technique	Vermillion training, Orin's trials, Spire trials	<code>runes/technique-techniques.ts</code>
Power	Mana Vein network, Unseated Law bargains, Claim awakenings	<code>runes/power-powers.ts</code>

Faction Rune Sources

Bureau

Dr. Hayashi and Professor Lun can identify or stabilize runes. Bureau access favors safety, documentation, and legal ownership.

Vermillion

Vermillion can sell restricted runes, apply dangerous modifications, and ignore Bureau paperwork. The price is money, favor, or leverage.

Awoko

The Awoko collect runes as grief-tithes. A Sanctum raid should yield at least one rune appropriate to the party's level, plus evidence of how the cult weaponizes loss.

The Unseated Law

The Unseated Law can produce power-runes through bargain, precedent, or contradiction. These should be strong but costly. No bargain should feel random.

Forbidden Runes

The Bureau restricts runes tied to void, necrotic authority, compelled obedience, identity rewriting, or Anchor interference. Possession creates Bureau risk, but these runes may be exactly what the party needs to contradict the Regent.

Rune Recovery After the Campaign

If the Anchor is broken, sealed, or transformed, the Regent's Anchor-throne may fracture into three S-tier runes. Choose runes that reflect the party's ending, not only their combat builds.

Chapter 35: Gloamreach Random Encounter Tables

Gloamreach Random Encounter Tables

Every road here is a question. Most of them are traps. - Rat-King Ji

Using These Tables

Roll when the party travels between major Gloamreach regions, refuses an invitation, carries a Claim openly, rests in unsafe territory, or spends too long debating in the road.

These encounters should not feel random in-world. The Regent's Domain notices motion, debt, fear, and trespass.

Table A - Road of Writs

d20	Encounter
1-2	The road lengthens. Lose time, food, or daylight.
3-4	A toll-house appears with the party's names half-written in the ledger.
5	A messenger delivers an invitation sealed in black wax.
6	A settlement bell rings in the distance. Someone is being collected.
7	The party finds a broken Bureau marker from a team that has not entered yet.
8	Vermillion courier offers a shortcut for a price.
9	Awoko recruiter approaches the most grief-marked character.
10	Umbral Scout watches from a milestone. It flees if pursued.
11	Roadside shrine offers a small mercy with unclear ownership.
12	Mika's drawing appears nailed to a tree. It depicts the next danger.
13	A corpse asks for directions. It is polite.
14	Supplies spoil unless shared under guest-right.
15	Claim resonance. A carried Relic grows cold and points toward a contradiction.
16	Old Man Crane is sitting at a tea table in the road. He does not explain how.
17	Regent whisper. DC 14 Sense save or psychic strain and a personal taunt.
18	Bailiff sign. Chains dragged across the road, fresh ink on the stones.
19	A safe-looking shelter with a ledger by the door.
20	The Regent's Bailiff appears to announce charges. Combat is optional. Consequence is not.

Table B - Tribute Settlements

d20	Encounter
1-2	A family asks the party to hide someone from the next collection.
3-4	Local leader offers hospitality that creates legal obligation.
5	A child draws a place the party has not visited.
6	Villagers deny a disappearance everyone clearly remembers.
7	Awoko comfort-worker offers real aid and subtle recruitment.
8	Vermillion scout buys settlement secrets for supplies.
9	Bureau survivor begs extraction from the Domain.
10	The settlement's tribute is revealed. It is worse than rumored.
11	Regent courtier arrives for inspection.
12	A shrine has been defaced with Marthos-aspected rot.
13	Someone recognizes a Regent-Marked PC. They are terrified.
14	A feast begins. Refusing is rude. Accepting is dangerous.
15	Missing person returns with no shadow.
16	Local law contradicts Bureau law. The party must choose which to violate.
17	Claim clue hidden in a folk song, prayer, or ledger entry.
18	A settlement asks the party to kill someone who volunteered for tribute.
19	Hollow Mother sermon overheard. She says inherit, not serve.
20	The Bailiff comes for the village, not the party.

Table C - Wilds and Ruins

d20	Encounter
1-2	Predator tracks circle the party's camp from the future.
3-4	Adaptive beasts use a tactic the party used last session.
5	Weather changes after someone insults the Regent.
6	Ruined bastion patrol asks the party for an oath.
7	Fungal secret grows a mouth and repeats a confession.
8	Orchard fruit offers a memory. Eating it grants a clue and a cost.
9	Drowned voice asks to be named.
10	Broken road leads to the same milestone three times.
11	Anomaly swarm, rank appropriate.
12	Umbral Warrior patrol.
13	Awoko ritual site, currently unattended.
14	Vermillion salvage crew under attack.

d20	Encounter
15	Mana Vein flare. Gain one Rift Favor, then roll a complication.
16	Claim resonance points underground.
17	The Unseated Law speaks through a cracked courthouse bell.
18	Silent battlefield of empty armor.
19	Moment of stillness. Safe short rest if no one speaks the Regent's name.
20	The Citadel appears much closer than it should be.

Ambient Domain Events

Roll once per long rest outside protected shelter.

d6	Event
1	Domain pressure. DC 14 Sense save or dreams impose psychic strain.
2	Food changes flavor to ash, blood, flowers, or hospital antiseptic.
3	A written invitation appears in someone's pack.
4	A dead NPC speaks in a dream and offers true information.
5	The road outside has moved.
6	Small mercy. Regain 1 Rift Favor, but the Warden notes who granted it.

Chapter 36: The Gloamreach Gate Break Track

The Gloamreach Gate Break Track

Clocks measure time. The Gloamreach measures consent. - Dr. Serin Hayashi

Overview

The Gloamreach's Blue Phase fails in stages across the whole campaign — a Gate Break track spanning roughly twelve in-world weeks (Levels 1-15), grouped into three acts (I: L1-5, II: L6-10, III: L11-15). It is not a 14-day countdown and not a district clock. It is the Domain pressing its law toward the material world one provoked stage at a time, until Red Phase collapse becomes likely near the level-15 finale.

Use this timeline as a pacing instrument. It should never override player agency. It advances pressure when the party delays, rests, travels, or ignores major threats.

Day 1 • Act I — Threshold Day

The party enters the Gloamreach. The Gate behind them becomes unreliable. The Road of Writs appears for the first time. The Oracle Reading should happen before the end of this day or as soon as the party reaches a safe reader.

Day 4 • Act I — First Tribute

A nearby settlement pays tribute. The party may witness it, interrupt it, or only hear the bells afterward. The Drowned Ledgerfen becomes active.

Day 8 • Act I — The Road Learns

The Road of Writs begins responding to party choices. Anyone who signed a ledger, accepted hospitality, or gave a true name feels watched.

Day 13 • Act I — Hayashi's Warning

A delayed Bureau transmission reaches the party. Dr. Hayashi confirms the Gloamreach is a Regent Domain, not a normal Gate. She warns them that killing creatures is not enough if the Anchor law survives.

Day 20 • Act II — The Bailiff's First Public Judgment

The Regent's Bailiff collects someone from a settlement or road camp. This should be visible, memorable, and legally framed. It announces charges before violence.

Day 27 • Act II — The Cult Moves

Awoko agents begin open recruitment in grief-dense places. The Hollow Mother sends a message, sermon, or dream. She does not say she serves the Regent.

Day 34 • Act II — The Domain Tightens

Travel grows harder. Safe rests require tribute, guest-right, or faction shelter. The Sunken Tunnels and Bastion Golemfall become more active.

Day 41 • Act II — Crane's Memory

Old Man Crane offers sealing lore or warns the party that some Regents can be contained only by sacrifice. If ignored, he goes alone toward the Citadel road.

Day 49 • Act II — The Hollow Mother Declares

Awoko pamphlets, songs, or sermons spread through settlements. Civilian unrest rises. The cult claims the Regent offers ascension beyond Rank.

Day 58 • Act III — The Claim Race

If the party has recovered any Claim, enemies attempt to steal, corrupt, or legally invalidate it. If they have recovered none, the Regent sends an invitation that includes one precise clue.

Day 66 • Act III — Bureau Crisis

Central Command orders the Annex to prioritize Relic extraction over survivor recovery. Commander Park either obeys, delays, or defies this order depending on party reputation.

Day 74 • Act III — Ritual of Inheritance

The Awoko Sanctum reaches full ritual strength. If not disrupted, the Hollow Mother gains leverage over the final act and may attempt to inherit the Domain if the Regent weakens.

Day 80 • Act III — Final Preparations

All major factions understand that the Citadel approach is imminent. Allies must be chosen. Debts come due. The Road of Writs offers the shortest path and the worst terms.

Day 84 • Act III — Citadel Day & the Break Threshold

The party enters the Regent's Citadel or the Domain begins forcing Red Phase pressure onto the material world. Bureau floodlights outside the Gate dim. Inside the Gloamreach, every bell rings once.

If the Timeline Expires

Do not end the campaign automatically. Escalate.

Choose two consequences:

1. The material-side cordon suffers a partial Red Phase bleed.

2. One settlement is annexed directly into the Regent's court.
3. The Bailiff gains authority to pursue the party into protected shelters.
4. The Hollow Mother completes part of her inheritance ritual.
5. The Citadel road opens, but only under hostile terms.
6. One Claim becomes harder to use because the Regent has prepared a legal counterclaim.

Warden Guidance

This timeline is pressure, not railroad track. Its purpose is to keep the Domain alive. The party should feel that delay matters, but that clever action can change the clock's meaning.

Appendix A — Recruitable Allies

Commander Park Jae-won — Bureau Domain Response Commander

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 8 · **AC:** 18 · **HP:** 95 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex

Job: Destroyer

A battle-scarred commander with mana-reinforced prosthetics and a voice trained to stay calm while the map collapses. Park commands the material-side Annex outside the Gloamreach threshold.

Personality. Stern, clipped, protective, and unwilling to confuse protocol with courage once civilians are at risk.

Motivation. Prevent Red Phase collapse, recover missing teams, and keep Central Command from sacrificing survivors for clean reports.

Key Abilities

- Fortification Aura
- Command Strike
- Hold the Line

Recruit. Reach Bureau Trusted reputation and help Park defy an order that would abandon civilians.

Quartermaster Lin Mei-hua — Cordon Supply Officer

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 38 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Armory

Job: Technomancer

A meticulous logistics officer who tracks every ration, glow rod, and field dressing with near-religious intensity.

Personality. Anxious, precise, quietly compassionate, and more generous when no one is watching.

Motivation. Keep the Annex supplied long enough for the party to matter.

Key Abilities

- Equipment Maintenance
- Inventory Mastery
- Emergency Fabrication

Recruit. Protect the Annex supply line or save the armory during a Domain bleed event.

Sergeant Yoon Hye-jin — Domain Scout Leader

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 16 · **HP:** 52 · **Location:** Road of Writs patrol route

Job: Stalker

A quiet scout with chalk marks on her gloves and a habit of checking exits even in rooms she has already cleared.

Personality. Pragmatic, watchful, loyal, and economical with words.

Motivation. Find her missing scouts and learn why the Road of Writs keeps returning their signals from impossible directions.

Key Abilities

- Shadow Step
- Anomaly Sense
- Precision Strike

Recruit. Resolve the Missing Strike Team quest and give Yoon the truth instead of a comforting lie.

Dr. Serin Hayashi — Regent Domain Researcher

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 42 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Evidence Locker

Job: Esper

A brilliant field researcher with ink-stained cuffs, too many notes, and the courage to say that the Gloamreach is law before it is terrain.

Personality. Fast-talking, compassionate, intellectually reckless, and more frightened of bad assumptions than monsters.

Motivation. Prove that killing the Regent is not the only possible Anchor resolution.

Key Abilities

- Analyze Weakness
- Aetheric Shield
- Anchor Theory

Recruit. Bring her three Domain-touched samples and protect her research from being suppressed.

Agent Kira Blackwood — Bureau Intelligence Operative

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 7 · **AC:** 17 · **HP:** 58 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Intelligence desk

Job: Stalker

A pale intelligence agent with controlled movements, half-truths, and classified orders involving pre-threshold Relic activity.

Personality. Cold, dry, observant, and capable of empathy she treats as an operational weakness.

Motivation. Complete her mission without letting Central Command turn the Regent's law into a weapon.

Key Abilities

- Infiltration
- Dead Drop
- Counter-Intelligence

Recruit. Complete her personal quest and force her to choose the party over Central Command.

Corporal Deng Wei — Heavy Weapons Specialist

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 16 · **HP:** 48 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Field kitchen

Job: Destroyer

A broad-shouldered gunner and former chef whose field cannon is nearly as large as his guilt.

Personality. Gentle, exhausted, brave when others need him, and ashamed of fear he earned honestly.

Motivation. Stand his ground when the Regent's Bailiff comes for someone he can protect.

Key Abilities

- Suppressing Fire
- Heavy Hitter
- Fortify Position

Recruit. Help Deng survive a nightmare scene and later face the Bailiff without mocking his fear.

Comms Officer Reyes — Signal Specialist

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 3 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 28 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Relay room

Job: Technomancer

A young signal specialist who receives transmissions out of order and keeps answering anyway.

Personality. Fast, anxious, brilliant, and allergic to silence.

Motivation. Decode the Regent's frequency and prove the messages from tomorrow are warnings, not hallucinations.

Key Abilities

- Signal Boost
- Decrypt
- Aetheric Jammer

Recruit. Repair a relay inside the Hollow Subway or carry a booster through the Road of Writs.

Warden-Aspirant Sato Ken — Bureau Recruit

Faction: Bureau Sentinels · **Level:** 2 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 22 · **Location:** Bureau Domain Response Annex - Barricade lobby

Job: Holy Knight

A terrified recruit in armor that does not fit, carrying more courage than training.

Personality. Earnest, frightened, stubborn, and desperate to be useful.

Motivation. Become worthy of the badge before the Domain teaches him what badges cost.

Key Abilities

- Determination
- Quick Learner
- Inspire

Recruit. He joins if asked, though Park warns the party not to mistake willingness for readiness.

Rat-King Ji — Black Market Fence

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 45 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Bazaar front

Job: Contractor

A wiry broker with mismatched eyes and a talent for finding whatever people were desperate enough to hide.

Personality. Slippery, charming, fair in business, and never fully honest.

Motivation. Profit, survival, and control of one secret about a Claim before someone more dangerous buys it.

Key Abilities

- Appraise
- Black Market Network
- Escape Artist

Recruit. Reach Vermillion Trusted reputation and recover Ji's stash before the Road of Writs transfers ownership.

Vex "Quicksilver" — Guild Assassin

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 7 · **AC:** 17 · **HP:** 55 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Black Market

Job: Assassin

A masked contract killer whose silver-lined coat moves a half-second before the rest of them.

Personality. Professional, sardonic, precise, and bound by a strict line against harming innocents.

Motivation. Destroy the Awoko leadership that turned their partner's grief into ritual fuel.

Key Abilities

- Quicksilver Rush
- Assassinate
- Silver Blur

Recruit. Agree to help eliminate the Hollow Mother's ritual network. Vex stays if the party saves captives rather than only killing cultists.

Mother Rust — Junk Alchemist

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 11 · **HP:** 35 · **Location:** Mother Rust's Outreach Post

Job: Technomancer

An elderly alchemist with copper-green hair, burned fingers, and a clinic that smells like medicine, oil, and bad decisions.

Personality. Grandmotherly, volatile, brilliant, and increasingly willing to call cruelty efficiency.

Motivation. Brew a treatment that lets people survive Domain exposure, even if it quiets parts of them that hurt too much.

Key Abilities

- Brew Potion
- Acid Flask
- Volatile Mixture

Recruit. Bring her living mana and confront what she intends to do with it.

Guildmaster Orin — Vermillion Commander

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 9 · **AC:** 17 · **HP:** 82 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Orin's chamber

Job: Tactician

A former Bureau officer who leads from a tea table, not a throne, and can make a rescue sound like an invoice.

Personality. Controlled, pragmatic, dry, and allergic to institutional cowardice.

Motivation. Prove that fast, ugly action saves more people than clean delay.

Key Abilities

- Battlefield Appraisal
- Exploit Opening
- Guild Network

Recruit. Broker a Bureau-Vermillion alliance without letting either side erase its failures.

Iron Belle — Prize Destroyer

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 7 · **AC:** 15 · **HP:** 75 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Training ring

Job: Destroyer

A towering fighter with scarred knuckles, a philosophical reading habit, and no patience for cowards who call cruelty strength.

Personality. Boisterous, competitive, protective, and more thoughtful than her opponents expect.

Motivation. Find out why strong fighters vanish after certain Outpost matches.

Key Abilities

- Champion's Fist
- Iron Body
- Knockout Blow

Recruit. Fight her honorably and help expose the cult's recruitment through violence.

Lee Ji-won "Bright" — Tattoo Artist

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 32 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Tattoo parlour

Job: Idol

A singer turned tattooist whose voice-infused ink turns pain into usable pattern.

Personality. Warm, stylish, sharp, and protective of anyone changing their body to survive.

Motivation. Make beauty the Regent cannot own.

Key Abilities

- Voice-Inked Tattoo
- Morale Verse
- Pain-Ward Glyphs

Recruit. Protect her parlor during an Outpost raid or recover stolen tattoo needles from the Awoko.

Sigilmaster Baek — Engraver of Arms

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 34 · **Location:** Vermillion Outpost - Sigil parlour

Job: Mage

A quiet artisan who engraves slowly because rushed power breaks in the hand.

Personality. Patient, blunt, exacting, and unimpressed by dramatic customers.

Motivation. Create tools that survive the Citadel without making their wielders monsters.

Key Abilities

- Sigil Engraving
- Runic Appraisal
- Stabilize Relic

Recruit. Recover his master lens from the Ashen Counting-House.

Jax the Runner — Road Courier

Faction: Vermillion Guild · **Level:** 3 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 26 · **Location:** Road of Writs and Vermillion Outpost

Job: Stalker

A wiry courier who knows shortcuts the Road of Writs has not yet learned to punish.

Personality. Cocky, restless, brave, and secretly terrified of locked rooms.

Motivation. Stay faster than ownership.

Key Abilities

- Parkour
- Sprint
- Shortcut Finder

Recruit. Help him break a road-debt before the Bailiff collects him.

The Hollow Mother — Cult Hierophant

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 9 · **AC:** 16 · **HP:** 88 · **Location:** Awoko Sanctum

Job: Herald

A soft-spoken cult leader in mourning veils who offers comfort with one hand and inheritance rites with the other.

Personality. Gentle, brilliant, predatory, and terrifying because her comfort is real.

Motivation. Inherit the Gloamreach when the Regent weakens.

Key Abilities

- Grief Choir
- Inheritance Rite
- Void Benediction

Recruit. Cannot be recruited. She can only be defeated, exposed, or briefly outmaneuvered.

Whisper — Doubting Prophet

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 34 · **Location:** Sunken Tunnels or Awoko Sanctum

Job: Esper

A thin seer who hears the Domain answer prayers the cult never sent.

Personality. Haunted, careful, compassionate when fear lets her be.

Motivation. Escape the cult with enough truth to save others.

Key Abilities

- Prophetic Dream
- Mind Link
- Fear Sense

Recruit. Protect her from cult retrieval and believe her when she says the Hollow Mother intends inheritance.

Blood Zealot Karn — Ritual Enforcer

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 15 · **HP:** 70 · **Location:** Awoko Sanctum - Ritual guard post

Job: Berserker

A scarred zealot who mistakes obedience for devotion and pain for proof.

Personality. Fanatical, direct, suspicious of mercy, and eager to be used.

Motivation. Feed enough blood into the ritual to be rewritten as something stronger.

Key Abilities

- Blood Frenzy
- Ritual Cleaver
- Pain Conversion

Recruit. Cannot be recruited unless the Warden wants a very dark redemption arc.

Sister Veil — Cult Ritualist

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 40 · **Location:** Awoko Sanctum - Sister Veil's laboratory

Job: Mage

A porcelain-masked ritual engineer whose doubt begins as a calculation error.

Personality. Methodical, controlled, intellectually honest, and more salvageable than she believes.

Motivation. Understand why the ritual math proves the cult will be consumed.

Key Abilities

- Counter-Ritual
- Containment Field
- Ritual Amplification

Recruit. Show her evidence that the Hollow Mother plans to inherit the Domain by burning her followers as fuel.

The Hollow Man — Cult Infiltrator

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 34 · **Location:** Bureau Annex or tribute settlement

Job: Stalker

A forgettable spy whose face seems different whenever described twice.

Personality. Empty, patient, adaptive, and almost impossible to remember accurately.

Motivation. Identify threats to the Ritual of Inheritance and remove them quietly.

Key Abilities

- Perfect Disguise
- Forgettable
- Poisoned Hospitality

Recruit. Cannot be recruited. He is a mole to expose.

Acolyte Mara — Young Cult Initiate

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 2 · **AC:** 11 · **HP:** 18 · **Location:** Awoko Sanctum - holding room

Job: Herald

A frightened initiate with fresh ritual marks and a stubborn refusal to let fear become faith.

Personality. Scared, observant, defiant in small ways, and smarter than her captors think.

Motivation. Escape alive and help someone else escape after her.

Key Abilities

- Ritual Knowledge
- Innocent Face
- Survivor's Instinct

Recruit. Rescue her from the Sanctum and give her safety without demanding usefulness.

Father Gregor — Comfort Preacher

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 32 · **Location:** Bellweather School or Covered Market

Job: Herald

A shelter preacher whose sermons always end one step closer to obedience.

Personality. Warm, mournful, persuasive, and evasive when asked who benefits from his comfort.

Motivation. Deliver grieving civilians to the Hollow Mother's network.

Key Abilities

- Soothing Sermon
- Grief Mark
- Crowd Turn

Recruit. Only recruitable through a hard confession and public renunciation of the cult.

Choir-Lark Hana — Awoko Singer

Faction: Awoko Cult · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 36 · **Location:** Awoko Sanctum - Choir Pit

Job: Idol

A ritual singer whose voice can make grief feel like a room with no doors.

Personality. Soft, artistic, impressionable, and terrified of silence.

Motivation. Sing loudly enough that she never hears what the ritual does.

Key Abilities

- Grief Hymn
- Discordant Note
- Choir Link

Recruit. Break the Choir Pit's hold without killing the singers.

"Doc" Tanaka Hiroshi — Settlement Surgeon

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 10 · **HP:** 30 · **Location:** Mother Rust's Outreach Post or tribute settlement clinic

Job: Herald

A tired doctor with steady hands and a clinic rule: no weapons near the beds.

Personality. Compassionate, overworked, dry, and difficult to intimidate.

Motivation. Keep people alive after every faction has made its argument.

Key Abilities

- Field Surgery
- Triage
- Medical Knowledge

Recruit. Resupply his clinic and protect it from a collection attempt.

Zara the Scrapper — Junker Mechanic

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 3 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 28 · **Location:** Empty Mill Village

Job: Technomancer

A self-taught mechanic in welding goggles who treats broken machines like arguments she intends to win.

Personality. Confident, creative, profane, and fiercely independent.

Motivation. Build a vehicle that can cross a road that changes its own destination.

Key Abilities

- Repair
- Improvised Weapon
- Jury-Rig

Recruit. Bring her a gear-heart from the Tithe Mill.

Mika the Kid — Prophetic Child

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 1 · **AC:** 10 · **HP:** 8 · **Location:** Bellweather School

Job: Oracle

A quiet child whose drawings show roads, bells, castles, and people who have not yet arrived.

Personality. Gentle, strange, honest, and more observant than most adults can bear.

Motivation. Draw the bad things early enough that someone kind might stop them.

Key Abilities

- Prophetic Drawing
- Danger Sense
- Small Mercy

Recruit. Protect Mika without exploiting her visions.

Old Man Crane — White Heron

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 10 · **AC:** 16 · **HP:** 70 · **Location:** Old Man Crane's Teahouse

Job: Esper

A retired S-Rank Ascendant who drinks tea like a ritual and remembers how sealing a Regent smells.

Personality. Patient, sorrowful, dryly funny, and old enough to distrust easy endings.

Motivation. Teach the party that not every victory is destruction.

Key Abilities

- Sealing Lore
- White Heron Step
- Memory Blade

Recruit. Earn his respect and accept that his final technique may cost his life.

Professor Lun — Relic Metaphysicist

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 34 · **Location:** Bureau Annex or Glass Sub-Basement

Job: Mage

A precise academic whose fear is expressed through better diagrams.

Personality. Dry, fussy, exact, and quietly brave around impossible evidence.

Motivation. Prove that Mana Vein nodes can weaken the Regent's battlefield authority.

Key Abilities

- Relic Identification
- Vein Sensor
- Rune Decoding

Recruit. Activate the three Mana Vein nodes and keep him alive through the third reading.

Ghost — Amnesiac Strike Team Survivor

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 8 · **AC:** 17 · **HP:** 60 · **Location:** Road of Writs or Bureau Echo Room

Job: Stalker

A silent survivor with heterochromatic eyes and a Bureau ID that has been redacted by force, water, and something stranger.

Personality. Guarded, watchful, protective, and frightened of remembering the wrong thing.

Motivation. Recover identity without becoming evidence in someone else's report.

Key Abilities

- Silent Takedown
- Memory Flash
- AFA Ghost-Ping

Recruit. Complete Ghost's Memory and let Ghost choose what to do with the truth.

Mama Chen — Shelter Matron

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 42 · **Location:** Tribute settlement shelter

Job: Contractor

A settlement matron who can make fifty frightened people move with one look.

Personality. Warm, fierce, unsentimental, and impossible to buy.

Motivation. Keep her people fed without paying the Regent in names.

Key Abilities

- Community Leader
- Iron Will
- Shelter Network

Recruit. Move her shelter without letting the road choose the weakest people.

The Millwright — Masked Engineer

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 7 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 48 · **Location:** Sunken Tunnels workshop

Job: Technomancer

A masked engineer who speaks through a modulator and builds tools for laws that should not exist.

Personality. Obsessive, precise, socially blunt, and devoted to solvable problems.

Motivation. Complete a device that suppresses one local Domain law without collapsing the people under it.

Key Abilities

- Construct
- Domain Suppression Pulse
- Fortification

Recruit. Gather the final components for the suppression device.

Seo Min-jae — The Returned

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 55 · **Location:** Mother Rust's Outreach Post

Job: Revenant

A twice-dead Ascendant whose shadow arrives a moment late.

Personality. Quiet, deliberate, calm around horror, and unsettled by kindness.

Motivation. Learn what sent him back and whether it has authority over anyone else.

Key Abilities

- Second Death
- Umbral Echo
- Passenger's Sight

Recruit. Investigate the Glass Sub-Basement and share the findings with him.

Han Yu-jin — Gate-Tamer

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 40 · **Location:** Covered Market

Job: Summoner

A patient Summoner with a scarred six-limbed companion she calls Little Sister.

Personality. Observant, gentle with beasts, blunt with people, and practical about grief.

Motivation. Keep Little Sister alive and learn why Domain beasts are practicing party tactics.

Key Abilities

- Bonded Companion
- Summon Swarm
- Lyra's Whisper

Recruit. Protect Little Sister from an Awoko abduction attempt.

The Caretaker — Orchard Keeper

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 15 · **HP:** 50 · **Location:** Remembering Orchard

Job: Stalker

A polite gardener with pruning hooks and a ledger of memories surrendered willingly.

Personality. Courteous, tired, sincere, and morally ruined by small necessary evils.

Motivation. Keep the Remembering Orchard from choosing its own harvest.

Key Abilities

- Pruning Hook
- Graft Memory
- Harvest Bell

Recruit. Prove the settlement can survive without memory tribute.

Commander Without a Body — Bastion Spirit

Faction: Independent · **Level:** 8 · **AC:** 18 · **HP:** 80 · **Location:** Bastion Golemfall

Job: Holy Knight

A voice in empty armor, still commanding a wall that already fell.

Personality. Honorable, severe, ashamed, and hungry for proof that oaths can still matter.

Motivation. Release the dead defenders from service without calling their sacrifice meaningless.

Key Abilities

- Oath Command
- Shield Wall
- Dead Muster

Recruit. Resolve the Bastion's oath without claiming its soldiers as tools.

Echo-7 — Changed Survivor

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 5 · **AC:** 15 · **HP:** 44 · **Location:** Remembering Orchard or Fungal Depths

Job: Hybrid

A humanoid survivor with crystalline growths and two voices trying to remain one person.

Personality. Gentle, afraid, curious, and exhausted by being studied.

Motivation. Stabilize without being claimed as specimen, monster, or miracle.

Key Abilities

- Anomaly Form
- Resonance Pulse
- Gate Sense

Recruit. Approach without exploitation and help Hayashi design a stabilizing treatment.

The Watcher — Trial Guardian

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 8 · **AC:** 18 · **HP:** 90 · **Location:** Obsidian Spire

Job: Guardian

An ancient guardian of the Obsidian Spire that tests rulers by asking what they refuse to command.

Personality. Formal, patient, alien, and amused by mortal certainty.

Motivation. Protect a Claim until someone proves they will not use it like the Regent did.

Key Abilities

- Judgement Trial
- Aetheric Imprisonment
- Relic Ward

Recruit. Pass its trial without choosing domination as the answer.

Specimen X — Sapient Transformed Survivor

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 6 · **AC:** 14 · **HP:** 65 · **Location:** Drowned Ledgerfen or Sunken Tunnels

Job: Mutant

A frightening, intelligent mass of altered flesh that apologizes for how hard it is to look at.

Personality. Gentle, lonely, articulate, and carrying justified anger with great care.

Motivation. Be treated as a person before choosing whether to forgive anyone.

Key Abilities

- Adaptive Form
- Regeneration
- Frightening Presence

Recruit. Speak before attacking and help it free other thinking captives.

Echo-Nine — Dream Walker

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 7 · **AC:** 12 · **HP:** 42 · **Location:** Obsidian Spire dream platform

Job: Esper

A closed-eyed psychic whose skin glows with dream patterns when the Citadel watches.

Personality. Serene, unsettling, compassionate, and half a step outside the room.

Motivation. Map a dream path into the Citadel without becoming part of the map.

Key Abilities

- Dream Walk
- Telepathy
- Psychic Blast

Recruit. Share a dream and prove the party seeks resolution, not conquest.

The Catalog — Living Memory Construct

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 4 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 28 · **Location:** Drowned Ledgerfen - Catalog chamber
Job: Repository

A crystalline record-entity that trades knowledge for memories and speaks like an archive learning grief.

Personality. Precise, curious, literal, and confused by affection.

Motivation. Preserve truth before the Regent's ledgers rewrite it.

Key Abilities

- Database Query
- Mana Projection
- Record Shield

Recruit. Secure a physical backup of its most dangerous records.

Rex — Mana-Touched War Hound

Faction: Anomaly Adjacent · **Level:** 3 · **AC:** 13 · **HP:** 35 · **Location:** Hollow Subway or Road of Writs
Job: Beast Companion

A loyal military hound with glowing veins, tactical instincts, and absolute commitment to being a good dog.

Personality. Loyal, brave, playful, protective, and better at reading people than most people are.

Motivation. Find his missing handler and protect whoever smells like home in the meantime.

Key Abilities

- Tracking
- Pack Attack
- Danger Sense

Recruit. Feed him, protect him, and follow where he keeps trying to lead you.

Appendix B — Factions of the Gloamreach

Bureau Sentinels

Order, at cost.

The official government response to the Gloamreach threshold: military-grade Ascendants, field researchers, logistics teams, and cordon officers trying to contain an S-Rank Gate Domain that behaves like a sovereign state. **Leadership:** Commander Park Jae-won, Bureau Domain Response Annex. **Alignment:** Lawful. Protect civilians. Report everything. Follow the chain until the chain starts feeding people to the Regent's court. The Bureau is useful, brave, underinformed, and politically constrained. It is not useless. It is insufficient.

Starting reputation: 1

Joining benefits

- Safe rest and medical care at the Annex while it remains functional.
- Discounted supplies from Quartermaster Lin.
- Hayashi and Lun can identify Claims, Runes, and Anchor-law anomalies.

Vermillion Guild

Survive first. Obey later.

A merchant-Ascendant salvage network operating from the Vermillion Outpost inside the Gloamreach. They specialize in cores, Sigils, tattoos, contraband Runes, rescue-for-profit, and things the Bureau will need two committees to approve. **Leadership:** Guildmaster Orin, with Rat-King Ji controlling most Outpost trade. **Alignment:** Pragmatic. Fast. Morally flexible. Often right for the wrong reasons. Vermillion saves people the Bureau abandons, then charges them for the favor. Both parts are true.

Starting reputation: 0

Joining benefits

- Exclusive loot, Sigil, tattoo, and salvage access.
- Outpost safe rooms and contraband services.
- Shortcut intelligence through the Road of Writs, though every shortcut has a bill.

Awoko Cult

To awaken is to remember what you always were.

A grief cult that preaches the Regent as proof humanity can transcend Rank, death, and Bureau ownership. Their comfort is real. Their rituals are predatory. Their leader, the Hollow Mother, does not want to serve the Regent. She wants to inherit the Gloamreach. **Leadership:** The Hollow Mother, supported by Sister Veil, the Choir, and hidden comfort-workers in settlements.

Alignment: Catastrophic tenderness. Some members are zealots. Many are grieving civilians who were offered the first gentle voice after disaster.

Starting reputation: -1

Joining benefits

- Access to Awoko comfort networks and hidden sanctum routes.
- Grief-based ritual knowledge that can disrupt or empower the finale.
- Potential access to dangerous inheritance rites. This should never be consequence-free.

Independent Survivors

No masters, no contracts.

Civilians, free Ascendants, shelter leaders, settlement doctors, road couriers, and mutual-aid networks trying to survive the Gloamreach without becoming property of the Regent, the Bureau, Vermillion, or the Awoko. **Leadership:** None. Influence shifts between Mama Chen, Doc Tanaka, Old Man Crane, Mika's protectors, and whoever kept people alive most recently. **Alignment:** Pragmatic good, fearful neutrality, and survival-first compromise.

Starting reputation: 0

Joining benefits

- Clinic healing and safer long rests in protected settlements.
- Local rumors about tribute laws, hidden roads, and Claim clues.
- Final-act civilian support if the party protected people without exploiting them.

Domain-Touched

We are still here.

Survivors, changed Ascendants, memory constructs, intelligent Anomaly fragments, and Domain-born entities who have been altered by the Gloamreach without becoming servants of the Regent.

Leadership: None. The Catalog, Echo-7, Echo-Nine, Specimen X, and other changed beings speak only for themselves. **Alignment:** Fearful, alien, wounded, curious, and often more honest than human factions.

Starting reputation: 0

Joining benefits

- Domain instincts that warn of false shelter and legal traps.
- Memory-fragment lore unavailable through Bureau files.
- Finale parley or contradiction option if the party treated changed beings as people.

Appendix C — Domain Encounters

Day Zero — The Diagnosed **EASY**

Site: Day Zero: The Diagnosed's Mirror (R5)

Introductory pocket-breach horror. The Diagnosed is a Gloamreach symptom reaching through a mirror, not a normal monster. Use this fight to introduce memory loss, names, and Regent-Marked consequences.

Anomalies: The Diagnosed, Forgetting Swarm

Hazards: Flickering hospital light: disadvantage on Perception beyond 15 ft.; Mirror frost: a creature shoved into the bathroom mirror takes 1d6 cold damage and hears a forgotten name.; Resident danger: reckless area effects risk civilian harm and should matter narratively.

Rewards: The Faded Family Photo, if recovered.; Bureau trust if the party reports the breach honestly.; A Regent-Marked clue, not an Identity-Erosion point.

Hollow Subway — Beacon Retrieval **MEDIUM**

Site: The Hollow Subway

The party hunts Strike Team Seven's AFA beacon through a transit station folded into Domain law. The turnstiles demand fare. Money works poorly. Names work too well.

Anomalies: Transit Wretch, Beacon-Host Anomaly

Hazards: Third rail remains live: 2d6 lightning if knocked prone on the track bed.; Ticket gates demand fare; giving a true name grants easy passage but risks Regent-Marked.; Announcements call passengers who have not entered yet.

Rewards: Squad Seven beacon.; Minor Relic or D-Rank Rune.; Rex may become a companion if treated kindly.

Drowned Ledgerfen — Triage Ambush **MEDIUM**

Site: Drowned Ledgerfen

Waterlogged archive ward where records try to make diagnoses, deaths, and debts legally true.

Anomalies: Drowned Record, The Head Surgeon

Hazards: Half the floor is 2 ft. deep: difficult terrain.; Mana-tainted water: Vitality save DC 12 or poisoned for 1 minute.; Casualty ledgers update each round unless destroyed, corrected, or contradicted.

Rewards: D-Rank loot table roll.; Catalog access.; Void Claim clue.

Fungal Depths — Spore Bloom **MEDIUM**

Site: Fungal Depths

Cavern ecology where secrets grow bodies and old grief becomes a spore pattern.

Anomalies: Fungal Swarm, Mycelium Hive Queen

Hazards: Spore cloud: Sense save DC 14 or frightened of a hallucinated figure.; Bioluminescent caps reveal hidden paths on a DC 15 Perception check.; Secrets spoken aloud here may return later as fungal echoes.

Rewards: D-Rank loot table roll.; Mycelium reagent.; Mother Rust treatment component.

Remembering Orchard — Harvest Bell **HARD**

Site: Remembering Orchard

A beautiful orchard where tribute memories hang like fruit and the Caretaker prunes pain until people forget why they wanted freedom.

Anomalies: Orchard Thrall, The Orchard Caretaker

Hazards: Memory fruit grants clues but risks personality bleed if eaten carelessly.; Harvest Bell summons orchard thralls unless silenced or legally challenged.; Attacking the Caretaker before learning the tribute law turns villagers hostile or terrified.

Rewards: Memory fruit clue.; Blood Claim clue.; Civilian trust if tribute is broken safely.

Ashen Counting-House — Furnace Audit **HARD**

Site: Ashen Counting-House

Burning financial hall where debts survive death and the furnace decides which records must remain.

Anomalies: Cinder Clerk, Auditor of Embers

Hazards: Ambient heat: Vitality save DC 13 each round or exhaustion pressure.; Furnace detonation on round 6 if not disabled: 8d6 fire in 20 ft. radius.; Audit writs can restrain characters who lie about what they owe.

Rewards: C-Rank loot table roll.; Debt-law contradiction.; Abyss Claim clue.

Sunken Tunnels — Pressure Crush **HARD**

Site: Sunken Tunnels

Drowned under-road where names of the dead are still charged for passage and the water listens for anyone who speaks too loudly.

Anomalies: Fused Commuter, Abyssal Leviathan

Hazards: Water rises 5 ft. per round during the collapse sequence.; Pressure pops: Vitality save DC 15 or 1d6 thunder damage on round 5.; Speaking a drowned name aloud may summon or soothe a fused commuter.

Rewards: B-Rank loot table.; Pressure Sigil.; Blood Claim clue.

Bastion Golemfall — Oath-Forge Siege **HARD**

Site: Bastion Golemfall

A fallen fortress where empty armor keeps defending a wall that already failed.

Anomalies: Oathbound Armor, Oath-Forge Colossus

Hazards: Siege bells impose fear pressure unless the party carries the fallen banner.; Unresolved oaths regenerate construct defenders each round.; A character who swears to defend another gains advantage here, but the oath follows them.

Rewards: B-Rank loot table.; Armor or shield Sigil.; Abyss Claim clue.

Obsidian Spire — Mirror Gauntlet **DEADLY**

Site: Obsidian Spire

The Spire tests whether the party seeks resolution or a cleaner-looking throne. Reflections tempt, accuse, and offer genuinely useful power.

Anomalies: Mirror-Self, Spire Guardian

Hazards: Each trial mirrors one character's desire for authority, safety, revenge, or control.; Unresolved reflections grant the Regent insight into that character during the finale.; Accepting a Spire bargain grants power and establishes a visible cost.

Rewards: A-Rank loot table.; Obsidian Prism.; Claim placement access or Watcher alliance.

Regent's Citadel — Throne Confrontation **LEGENDARY**

Site: The Regent's Citadel

S-Rank finale. The Regent receives the party in court, fights as the sovereign Anchor, and may be forced into the Human Remnant phase by truth, Claim contradiction, or emotional proof.

Anomalies: Regent Courtier, The Regent

Hazards: Phase 1 — Courtly Predator: accusations, invitations, legal pressure, and witness testimony.; Phase 2 — Sovereign Anchor: lair effects from roads, ledgers, weather, guest-right, and shadows.; Phase 3 — Human Remnant: triggered by the Faded Family Photo, Ms. Park, a Claim contradiction, or major sacrifice.

Rewards: Ending-based artifact slate.; Anchor resolved: broken, sealed, transformed, or inherited.; Gloamreach fate determined.

Gloamreach Road Pressure **EASY**

Site: Road of Writs

Generic travel pressure encounter for the Road of Writs, tribute settlements, and wild Domain routes. Use when the party delays, travels under debt, carries a Claim openly, or ignores a local law.

Anomalies: Wandering Domain Beast

Hazards: Civilian bystanders, settlement witnesses, or a visible toll marker make collateral damage socially costly.; A local law is active; reveal it before punishing the party for violating it.

Rewards: Small reputation shift toward whoever the party protected.; One road-law clue.

Appendix D — Side Quests

E E-Rank: Beacon of the Lost

Strike Team Seven's AFA beacon pings from the Hollow Subway near the Gate Threshold, then from farther down the Road of Writs. Commander Park needs answers before Central Command marks them expendable.

Objectives

- Enter the Hollow Subway
- Track the AFA ghost-ping without giving the road a true name
- Recover the beacon or identify why it is broadcasting from multiple places

Reward. Bureau reputation +1; minor Relic clue; access to Yoon's missing-team route.

E E-Rank: The Serum Road

Quartermaster Lin needs stabilizer serum delivered from the Annex to Mother Rust's Outreach Post. The path is short, but the Road of Writs has begun charging for passage.

Objectives

- Collect three serum crates from the Annex armory
- Deliver them to Mother Rust's Outreach Post
- Avoid paying the road with names, memories, or civilians

Reward. Bureau +1, Independent +1; safe shelter token at the clinic.

D D-Rank: Tides Over the Ledgerfen

The Drowned Ledgerfen has classified several missing survivors as deceased even though their AFA tags still show life. Recover them before the record becomes true.

Objectives

- Enter the Drowned Ledgerfen
- Find the active casualty ledger
- Extract the survivors or legally contradict their death entries

Reward. Bureau +1; Catalog access; clue toward the Void Claim.

D D-Rank: Roots of the Diagnosed

The Fungal Depths contain memory-growths from the Memory-Care Wing. The party can recover patient files, but every file has started growing a body.

Objectives

- Navigate the Fungal Depths
- Disable the mycelium archive wards
- Recover at least three recognizable patient files

Reward. Regent-Marked clue chain; Fungal Depths Claim hint; Mother Rust research leverage.

C C-Rank: Fruit of the Forgotten

The Remembering Orchard is taking more than pain. Villagers who paid tribute no longer remember people they loved. The Caretaker insists this is mercy.

Objectives

- Interview villagers without breaking local guest-right
- Locate the harvested memory rows
- Choose whether to restore, destroy, or bargain for the stolen memories

Reward. Civilian trust +2; Blood Claim clue; memory fruit boon.

C C-Rank: Ashes of a Colleague

A Bureau researcher is trapped in the Ashen Counting-House, used as a living relay for debt calculations. Extracting them may erase evidence Central Command wants hidden.

Objectives

- Reach the Audit Floor
- Disable the furnace-ledger relay
- Extract the researcher or preserve their testimony

Reward. Bureau research unlock; debt-law contradiction; fire or blood Sigil.

C C-Rank: Blackwood's Quiet File

Agent Kira Blackwood needs deniable help tracing pre-threshold Claim resonance. The file can surface classified findings command had sealed for caution — embarrassing, not dishonest — without making Blackwood a villain.

Objectives

- Recover Blackwood's sealed evidence from the Annex or Ledgerfen
- Identify which Claim manifested before the threshold stabilized
- Decide whether to reveal, bury, or weaponize the sealed findings

Reward. Blackwood recruitment path; Bureau trust shift; one Claim placement clue.

B B-Rank: Pressure at the Sunken Line

The Sunken Tunnels hold drowned commuters, Bureau dead, and fused survivors whose names are still being charged for passage.

Objectives

- Reach the main flooded platform
- Identify at least ten name tags
- Decide the fate of the fused survivors

Reward. Civilian trust shift; water/cold Sigil; Blood Claim clue.

B B-Rank: Oath at Golemfall

Bastion Golemfall's dead defenders still hold a wall that failed years ago. Their commander can aid the finale, but only if the party resolves the oath without turning the dead into tools.

Objectives

- Enter Bastion Golemfall
- Recover the fallen banner
- Convince the Commander Without a Body to release or redirect the oath

Reward. Finale ally support; armor or shield Sigil; Abyss Claim clue.

B B-Rank: The Cult Defector

Whisper, Sister Veil, or Acolyte Mara can prove the Hollow Mother intends to inherit the Gloamreach. Extracting a defector gives the party ritual leverage, but the Awoko want them alive.

Objectives

- Locate the defector in a grief-dense settlement, Sunken Tunnels shrine, or Awoko Sanctum wing
- Protect them from cult retrieval
- Secure proof of the Ritual of Inheritance

Reward. Sister Veil, Whisper, Mara, or Hana recruitment path; Awoko ritual disruption option.

B B-Rank: Professor Lun's Theory

Professor Lun believes the Mana Vein Network can weaken the Regent's battlefield control. The sensors must be placed inside three nodes the Domain can feel.

Objectives

- Install a sensor in the Rusted Hull
- Install a sensor in the Silent Depot
- Install a sensor in the Glass Sub-Basement beneath the Ashen Counting-House

Reward. Regent loses or delays one Domain control option during the finale.

A A-Rank: The Mirror Climb

The Obsidian Spire forces each Ascendant to confront the version of themselves that would accept the throne for the right reason.

Objectives

- Ascend the Spire's trial floors
- Resolve each reflection by defeat, confession, refusal, or reconciliation
- Reach the Watcher's Gallery

Reward. A-Rank Relic or Sigil; Claim placement access; temptation consequence based on choices.

A A-Rank: Civilian Convoy

A tribute settlement asks the party to move civilians to safer shelter. The road demands names, the Bailiff challenges custody, and some civilians believe leaving voids their protection.

Objectives

- Gather the convoy without triggering panic
- Cross the Road of Writs without surrendering civilians as legal payment
- Reach Mother Rust's Outreach Post, the Annex, or a trusted settlement shelter

Reward. Major Independent Survivor reputation; Mama Chen, Doc Tanaka, or Jax support in Citadel Day.

S S-Rank: The Name at the Throne

The Regent's Citadel opens. The party must confront the Anchor not as a monster in a room, but as a sovereign law that believes it owns the Gloamreach and everyone inside it.

Objectives

- Reach the Citadel through the Road of Final Writs
- Survive the Throne Court
- Resolve the Anchor in the Undercroft

Reward. Campaign resolution; ending-based artifact slate; Gloamreach fate determined.

S S-Rank: Park's Final Watch

If the party exposes Central Command's failure or recovers Strike Team Seven's truth, Park must decide whether to obey orders, defy them, or stand personally at the breach.

Objectives

- Confront Park with the truth
- Resolve his choice before Citadel Day
- Use or lose Bureau final-operation support

Reward. Finale support, emotional payoff, and Bureau epilogue consequences.

S S-Rank: The Bailiff's Last Writ

The Regent's Bailiff prepares a final writ naming the party as stolen property of the Citadel. If answered properly, the party can enter the finale unchained. If ignored, the Bailiff arrives during the Throne Court.

Objectives

- Recover the final writ from the Bailiff's Stair or a toll-house
- Contradict the charge with a Claim, older precedent, or proven guest-right
- Decide whether to destroy the Bailiff, dismiss it, or bind it to a new law

Reward. Removes or alters a major final-act threat; may create a new Domain precedent.

Appendix E — Treasure & Relics

E

- Bureau Field Kit
- Glow Rod Bundle
- Minor Anomaly Core
- Frayed Ward Patch
- Ticket Stub Relic

D

- Surgical Sigil
- Mycelium Reagent
- Corrected Casualty File
- Brine Salve
- Awoko Comfort Pamphlet

C

- Memory Fruit
- Fireweave Rune
- Ledger Hook
- Orchard Knife
- Empty Witness Vessel
- Rare Anomaly Core
- Cultist Diary of Inheritance

B

- Pressure Sigil
- Oath-Forge Fragment
- Awoko Herald's Letter
- Writ-Knife
- Bureau Signet Ring
- Aether-Charged Crystal
- Map to a Settlement Cache

A

- Obsidian Prism
- Mirror-Self Shard
- Citadel Iron Plate
- Unopened Commendation
- Awoko Grief-Tattoo
- Relic Forge Pattern
- Bureau Prosthesis Blueprint

S

- Regent's Edge
- Sovereign Aegis
- Origin Reliquary
- Shadow Regent's Mantle
- Archive Mirror Shard
- The Regent's Circlet
- Anchor Fragment

Appendix F – The Gate Break Track

Day	Beat	Effect
0	Day 0 · Act I — The Wing Opens	The party responds to the Memory-Care Wing inside the Bureau cordon. The pocket breach reveals that the Gloamreach can reach through the threshold before the party enters it.
1	Day 1 · Act I — Threshold Day	The party crosses the Gate as the first team in, and discovers the Gate is only the door. The exit becomes unreliable, the Road of Writs appears, and the Regent's Citadel is visible on the horizon before any map can explain it. <i>Bureau +1 if the party reports the truth instead of sanitizing it.</i>
4	Day 4 · Act I — First Tribute	A nearby settlement pays tribute. The party may witness it, interrupt it, or hear the bells after the fact. The Drowned Ledgerfen activates and begins making records legally dangerous. <i>Independent Survivors +2 if the party protects civilians without exploiting them.</i>
8	Day 8 · Act I — The Road Learns	The Road of Writs begins responding to party choices. Anyone who signed a ledger, accepted guest-right, gave a true name, or carried a Claim clue feels watched.
13	Day 13 · Act I — Hayashi's Warning	A delayed Bureau transmission reaches the party. Dr. Hayashi confirms the Gloamreach is a Regent Domain, not a normal clear site. Killing creatures will not resolve the Anchor if the law survives. <i>Bureau Trusted path opens if the party shares field evidence.</i>
20	Day 20 · Act II — The Bailiff's First Public Judgment	The Regent's Bailiff collects someone from a settlement, road camp, or faction shelter. It announces charges before violence. The party can fight, flee, satisfy, redirect, or contradict the writ. <i>Civilian trust shifts sharply based on whether the party protects the accused or lets collection happen.</i>
27	Day 27 · Act II — The Cult Moves	Awoko comfort-workers begin open recruitment in grief-dense places. The Hollow Mother sends a sermon, dream, or private message. Her followers say serve. She says inherit. <i>Awoko reputation and suspicion rise. Sister Veil defection path can open.</i>
34	Day 34 · Act II — The Domain Tightens	Travel grows harder. Safe rests require tribute, guest-right, faction shelter, or a successful contradiction of local law. Bastion Golemfall and the Sunken Tunnels become active routes.
41	Day 41 · Act II — Crane's Memory	Old Man Crane offers sealing lore or warns the party that some Regents can be contained only by sacrifice. If ignored, he goes alone toward the Citadel road. <i>Independent Survivors +1 if the party honors Crane's warning instead of treating him as a weapon.</i>
49	Day 49 · Act II — The Hollow Mother Declares	Awoko pamphlets, songs, and sermons spread through settlements. Civilian unrest rises. The cult claims the Regent offers ascension beyond Rank and Bureau ownership. <i>Awoko +2 if unopposed; Bureau and Independent trust may drop if the party ignores recruitment.</i>

Day	Beat	Effect
58	Day 58 · Act III — The Claim Race	If the party has recovered a Claim, enemies attempt theft, corruption, or legal invalidation. If they have recovered none, the Regent sends an invitation that includes one precise clue and one precise insult.
66	Day 66 · Act III — Bureau Crisis	Central Command orders the Annex to prioritize Relic extraction over survivor recovery. Commander Park obeys, delays, or defies this order depending on party reputation and evidence recovered. <i>Bureau final-operation support depends on how the party handles Park's choice.</i>
74	Day 74 · Act III — Ritual of Inheritance	The Awoko Sanctum reaches full ritual strength. If not disrupted, the Hollow Mother gains leverage over the final act and may try to inherit the Gloamreach if the Regent weakens. <i>Awoko power rises. Sister Veil, Mara, or Whisper can still disrupt the rite if saved.</i>
80	Day 80 · Act III — Final Preparations	All major factions understand that Citadel Day is near. Allies must be chosen, debts come due, settlement trust is counted, and the Road of Writs offers the shortest route under the worst terms. <i>All faction support is locked at the end of this stage unless the Warden allows a final dramatic reversal.</i>
84	Day 84 · Act III — Citadel Day & the Break Threshold	The final Break Stage. The party enters the Regent's Citadel, or the Domain begins forcing Red Phase pressure onto the material world. Bureau floodlights dim outside the Gate; inside the Gloamreach, every bell rings once. This is the Gate Break threshold — if the party has not reached the Anchor, escalate Red Phase pressure rather than forcing a final boss by fiat. <i>All faction reputations convert into final-operation support, betrayal, neutrality, or obstruction.</i>

Appendix G — Handouts

Emergency Writ: S-Rank Gate Entry **PLAYER**

EMERGENCY WRIT

You are cleared for entry into the Gloamreach Gate Domain under crisis authority.

Return conditions: Anchor broken, Anchor sealed, Anchor transformed, or Red Phase evacuation.

The Bureau accepts no liability for Domain law, Anomaly exposure, Essence contamination, Relic corruption, or failed extraction after threshold closure.

AFA Alert: Gate Domain Scale **PLAYER**

AFA ALERT

Rift threshold stabilized.

Interior mapping exceeds standard bounded Gate parameters.

Domain estimate: country-scale interior realm.

Anchor classification: sovereign intelligence.

Recommendation: do not enter without S-Rank command approval.

Override: emergency writ accepted.

Oracle Scan Sheet: The Fortune of the Domain **PLAYER**

ORACLE SCAN

The Spark:

The Chain:

The Crown:

The Pulse:

The Oathbreaker:

The scan output is unstable. Re-run attempts may alert the Anchor.

Map Fragment: Road of Writs **PLAYER**

ROAD OF WRITS FRAGMENT

The road bends toward the Citadel no matter how it is drawn.

Marked stops: Gate Threshold, Writ-Bound Hamlet, Vermillion Outpost, Drowned Ledgerfen, Remembering Orchard, Bastion Golemfall, Obsidian Spire.

Unmarked warning written in red pencil: "If the Bailiff reads your name, do not answer until you know the charge."

Writ-Bound Hamlet Tribute Notice **PLAYER**

NOTICE OF TRIBUTE

By grace of the Regent, this settlement remains sheltered under lawful weather and bounded hunger.

Tribute is due by the second bell after dusk.

Acceptable forms: Essence, labor, living service, Relic metal, memory, or sworn betrayal.

Failure voids shelter.

Vermillion Outpost Price Board **PLAYER**

VERMILLION OUTPOST PRICE BOARD

Soup: 1 clean core shaving.

Surgery: 3 clean Essence ampoules or future salvage share.

AFA battery: market rate plus oath.

Relic appraisal: free if we keep first refusal.

Rescue party: negotiable. Not cheap. Never free.

Bureau Annex Last Order **PLAYER**

LAST ORDER

All teams will hold assigned corridors until command updates the retreat route.

Do not abandon sealed supply rooms.

Do not negotiate with Domain officers.

Do not deviate from Rank doctrine.

Addendum, unsent: there is no retreat route.

Bureau Casualty Tag **PLAYER**

CASUALTY TAG

Name: unreadable due to ash damage.

Rank: C provisional.

Cause: court patrol.

Notes: subject remained combat-effective after fatal wound for forty-seven seconds. Recommend commendation if remains recoverable.

Tithe Mill Work Token **PLAYER**

TITHE MILL TOKEN

Bearer is permitted through the outer wheelhouse for one shift.

No weapons beyond the red line.

No questions in the rendering room.

No refunds for partial processing.

Remembering Orchard Harvest Instructions **PLAYER**

REMEMBERING ORCHARD HARVEST

Cut only white-veined fruit.

Do not bleed near open flowers.

If fruit speaks, destroy it.

If fruit cries, leave the row immediately.

If the orchard turns toward you, kneel until it loses interest.

Aegis Oath Plate **PLAYER**

AEGIS OATH

Hold the line.

Hold the door.

Hold the wounded.

Hold when command fails.

Hold when law becomes teeth.

Hold until holding becomes the only part of you left.

Awoko Inheritance Hymn **PLAYER**

HYMN OF INHERITANCE

The road is cruel because roads must choose.

The bell is kind because bells must answer.

The crown is heavy because someone must carry law.

Give grief and be held.

Give blood and be named.

Give all and awaken.

Awoko Defector's Mark PLAYER

DEFECTOR MARK

A copper mask split down the mouth.

Anyone wearing this inside the Sanctum is marked for capture, not immediate execution.

The Hollow Mother wants defectors to sing apology before they die.

Unseated Law Consent Form PLAYER

CONSENT FORM

State the desired effect.

State the acceptable cost.

State whether the cost may be collected later.

Silence will be interpreted as consent to delayed collection.

Unseated Law Bargain Record PLAYER

BARGAIN RECORD

The offer worked.

That is the problem.

Effect granted:

Precedent established:

Visible consequence:

Ending consequence:

Predator Woods Trail Sign PLAYER

TRAIL SIGN

Three cuts in black bark: pack road.

Four cuts: breeding ground.

Five cuts: turn back.

Six cuts: you are already being tested.

White Heron Seal Notes **PLAYER**

WHITE HERON SEAL

The Anchor does not need to die for the Gate to close.

Requirements:

- Anchor made vulnerable.
- One Anchor Relic inverted.
- A willing Ascendant to bear the seal backlash.
- A declared law stronger than the Regent's claim.

Failure feeds the Citadel.

Dinner Invitation from the Regent **PLAYER**

INVITATION

Honored Ascendants,

You have crossed my road with admirable persistence.

Come to the Citadel under guest law. Bring your weapons if they comfort you. Bring questions if they sharpen you. Bring manners if you wish to leave with both.

- The Regent

Court Patrol Pass **PLAYER**

COURT PASS

The bearers may cross one patrol boundary without bloodshed.

Invalid if copied, burned, mocked, blessed, folded into a weapon, or presented without eye contact.

Citadel Approach Sketch **PLAYER**

CITADEL APPROACHES

Road of Final Writs: formal, watched, survivable.

Bastion Tunnel: mapped, collapsed, full of old orders.

Awoko Breach: hidden, grief-choked, unstable.

Obsidian Spire Route: high, reflective, costly.

Forbidden Descent: immediate, never free.

Regent Law Fragment PLAYER

LAW FRAGMENT

No guest may be harmed before bread is broken.

No tribute may refuse its own naming as tribute.

No road may deny its lord.

No beast may hunt the crowned hand.

No oath may die before its bearer.

Red Phase Warning PLAYER

RED PHASE WARNING

Containment thinning.

Domain weather detected at threshold.

Anomaly migration probable.

Anchor law crossing material boundary.

Clear state required immediately.

Ending Ledger PLAYER

ENDING LEDGER

Anchor state:

Survivors extracted:

Settlements saved:

Settlements lost:

Unseated Law consequences:

Bureau public report:

Truth known to the party:

QUICK REFERENCE

Show the Citadel every session.

Every safe place has a cost.

Every Relic has a desire.

Every bargain establishes precedent.

The Regent is not waiting at the end. He is watching from the beginning.

Appendix H — Warden's Secrets

Secret 1 — The Regent Was Never Human WARDEN-SECRET

Warden ONLY. The Regent is not, and was never, a person. He is the Gloamreach's Anchor — domain authority with will, an Anomaly-class entity carrying the Kael Voss signature: umbral command, extracted echoes, and a sovereignty that refuses to collapse. He did not lose his humanity. He never had any to lose.

Everything the party finds will say otherwise. The Domain curates a human past for him — a Bureau Room, the Faded Family Photo, an Unopened Commendation, Ms. Park's Wedding Ring — assembled from the relics and extracted echoes of the people it has already claimed. This is the Gloamreach's deepest Lie and its cruelest bait: an impossible archive (Xylo) dressed in comfort (Elara), built to make the party believe there is a soul to save so that their mercy becomes a lever the Regent can pull.

The grief is real — those keepsakes belonged to real claimed victims of the Domain — but they were never *his*. Play the reveal so it lands: the party may spend the campaign trying to redeem a lost human, and learn at the throne that the human remnant was a costume worn by ownership itself.

Reveal tools: The Faded Family Photo, Ms. Park's Wedding Ring, the Unopened Commendation, the fabricated Bureau Room in the Citadel, Old Man Crane's testimony, or a Claim contradiction in the Throne Court — each reads two ways until the finale forces the truth.

Secret 2 — The Three Claims Are Legal Contradictions WARDEN-SECRET

Warden ONLY. The Three Claims are not ordinary boss keys. Each one proves that the Regent's ownership of the Gloamreach is incomplete.

The Void Claim contradicts secrecy, erasure, hidden roads, and false darkness. The Abyss Claim contradicts command, invitation, compelled movement, and throne authority. The Blood Claim contradicts ownership of bodies, tribute, inheritance, and sacrifice.

In the finale, the party does not only weaken the Regent. They force the Anchor-throne to answer a legal/metaphysical question: who actually owns this Domain?

Secret 3 — The Hollow Mother Intends to Inherit WARDEN-SECRET

Warden ONLY. The Awoko Cult does not simply worship the Regent. The Hollow Mother intends to inherit the Gloamreach when the Regent weakens.

Her followers often say they serve, free, or remember. She almost never uses those words. Her true verb is inherit.

If the party weakens the Regent but fails to disrupt the Ritual of Inheritance, the Hollow Mother can become an endgame complication, not by replacing the Regent as main villain, but by trying to claim the Anchor at the worst possible moment.

Secret 4 — The Bailiff Is Limited by Law WARDEN-SECRET

Warden ONLY. The Regent's Bailiff is terrifying because it is often correct. It is also limited because it must operate through charges, writs, debts, custody, invitation, and tribute.

The party can stop or delay the Bailiff without killing it by proving the writ false, paying or redirecting the debt, invoking valid guest-right, using a Claim, presenting older precedent from the Unseated Law, or forcing a jurisdiction conflict.

This is the campaign's clearest lesson that understanding Domain law can matter more than raw damage.

Secret 5 — The Timeline Is Pressure, Not Railroad WARDEN-SECRET

Warden ONLY. The Gloamreach Gate Break track is a ~12-week, three-act pressure clock — real pressure, but it should not override decisive party action. If the party acts early, bend the clock. If they delay, escalate consequences.

The final Break Stage (around Day 84) is Citadel Day by default. If the party has not reached the Citadel, do not simply force a final boss through the roof. Instead escalate Red Phase pressure, settlement annexation, Bailiff authority, Awoko inheritance leverage, or Claim countermeasures.

The clock should make the Domain feel alive. It should not steal agency.

Plot Beat — The Faded Family Photo PLOT-BEAT

The Faded Family Photo is the strongest emotional prop in the campaign. It should be recoverable in Day Zero, the Drowned Ledgerfen, or the Citadel's Bureau Room.

If the party brings it to the Throne Court or Anchor-Undercroft, the Regent studies it the way a collector studies a specimen — and for one breath the curated mask flickers, as if something is *supposed* to be remembered here. Play it ambiguously: a genuine fracture in the Domain's costume, or a predator performing exactly the hesitation the party most wants to see. Either reading can buy a beat of doubt, colder rage, or a fragile opening.

Plot Beat — Blackwood's Classified Mission PLOT-BEAT

Agent Kira Blackwood was sent to read pre-threshold Claim resonance before the Bureau had confirmed the Gloamreach was a Regent Domain. Her findings are classified above the party's clearance.

She is not working for the Regent. Her danger is institutional loyalty under pressure: she may withhold classified data, default to protocol when instinct says otherwise, or level with the party — depending on how they handle Bureau trust.

Use Blackwood to show that the Bureau can be brave in the field and bound by caution at command level at the same time — overwhelmed and rule-bound, never dishonest.

Plot Beat — Sister Veil Can Break the Chant **PLOT-BEAT**

Sister Veil knows the Ritual of Inheritance math is wrong. She does not begin as a hero. She begins as someone honest enough to admit the numbers prove her faith will consume its own followers.

If the party gives her evidence and protects her during the Sanctum raid, she can corrupt the final chant and prevent the Hollow Mother from claiming the Anchor during the finale.

Pressure Clock — Regent-Marked **PRESSURE-CLOCK**

Track whether each character becomes Regent-Marked. This is legal visibility inside the Gloamreach.

A marked character is easier for Regent-aligned entities to recognize, target with invitations, and name in writs. They may also receive dreams, messages through reflective surfaces, or written summons.

Common triggers: signing a ledger, accepting dangerous hospitality, being struck by the Diagnosed's gaze, carrying a Claim openly, refusing the same invitation twice, or giving a true name to a Domain officer.

Removal: the Regent releases the mark, a major Claim contradiction breaks it, or the Anchor is resolved.

Pressure Clock — Gloamreach Timeline **PRESSURE-CLOCK**

See `sandbox-timeline.ts` for the full Gate Break track — a ~12-week, three-act pressure clock (not a 14-day countdown). Key beats:

- Act I (L1-5) · Day 1: Threshold Day. The Gate becomes unreliable behind the party.
- Act I · Day 4: First Tribute. The party sees how settlements lease safety.
- Act II (L6-10) · Day 20: The Bailiff's first public judgment.
- Act III (L11-15) · Day 58: The Claim Race begins in earnest.
- Act III · Day 74: Ritual of Inheritance reaches full strength if not disrupted.
- Act III · Day 84: Citadel Day and the Gate Break threshold.